

This List Tastes Like Death by Rock and Roll

vs the Lone Star Open 2026 field · 324 lists / 117 archetypes · 120 games/matchup · **Version 1.0 · 2026-07-30**

Your locked disposition: **purge-the-foe**

Read this first: the **VERDICT** + *how-to-play* are hand-set from the Knights seat — that is the plan. The **Sim** column is the positional simulator: **directional only** (it over-credits you in melee and vs reanimation/hordes), a cross-check, not a prediction.

Matchup map

# Pilots	Archetype	Verdict	Sim	Board	How to play (short)
11	Shield Host Adeptus Custodes	FAVOURABLE	FAVOURED	+0.81	Elite-but-FEW (W3-4, ~40 models).
11	Valourstrike Lance Imperial Knights	MIRROR	FAVOURED	+0.63	Knightball mirror (your own build).
10	Librarius Conclave Space Marines (Astartes)	COIN-FLIP → hard	HARD	-0.64	The Great Value engine: Dev-Wound Sternguard + Librarian Conclave discipline + Oath re-rolls stack a volley that IGNORES your invuln.
10	Cursed Legion Necrons	UNFAVOURABLE	FAVOURED	+0.32	54 Cold-Fervour Gauss (S7 AP-2 Lethal) + reanimation + out-OC, often an un-killable Void Dragon.
10	Awakened Dynasty Necrons	HARD / play-the-mission	FAVOURED	+0.79	Un-killable: C'tan T11 W16 4++, -1 to incoming Damage, necrodermis return.
9	Assimilation Swarm Tyranids	COIN-FLIP	FAVOURED	+0.92	5-Norn monster-mash w/ heal/regen + OC15 anchors.
8	Coterie of the Conceited Emperor's Children	COIN-FLIP	FAVOURED	+0.81	Fulgrim + fast Slaaneshi melee (re-roll charges, hits above weight).
7	Retaliation Cadre T'au Empire	UNFAVOURABLE	HARD	-1.21	Railgun Dev-Wounds + markerlight AP-volume + fusion; they fall-back-and-shoot and evasion neuters your melee.
7	Needgaård Oathband Leagues of Votann	COIN-FLIP	EVEN	-1.33	Deep-strike Berserk maul-swarm (Anti-Vehicle 3+ MELEE wounds you regardless of S) + ~2 Land Fortresses.
7	Company of Hunters Dark Angels	UNFAVOURABLE	ATTRITION-NEGATIVE	-2.21	Catechism Dev-Wound plasma + Black Knight Anti-Vehicle melee + 90-bike out-OC on Disruption + they fall-back-

and-shoot.

6	Wrath of the Rock Dark Angels	HARD	HARD	-0.75	Deathwing terminator bricks: 2+/4+++, -1 Dmg, army-wide OC, NO decapitation target.
6	Banishers Grey Knights	COIN-FLIP → directional	FAVOURED	+0.75	Elite terminators (2+/4+++/5W) + teleport + psychic Dev-Wounds (ignore invuln) + deep strike.
6	Experimental Prototype Cadre T'au Empire	UNFAVOURABLE	FAVOURED	+0.84	As Retaliation — railgun Dev-Wounds + markerlight stacking.
6	Vanguard Onslaught Tyranids	COIN-FLIP → directional	FAVOURED	+1.09	Recon-disposition speed/infiltrate build — they out-tempo and grab early.
5	Librarius Conclave Dark Angels	COIN-FLIP → hard	FAVOURED	+0.95	As the SM Conclave — Dev-Wound plasma/Sternguard + psychic buffs that bypass invuln.
5	Skysplinter Assault Drukhari	FAVOURABLE	FAVOURED	+1.25	Their Lethal/Decapitating keywords are NON-Vehicle → they don't touch your Knights, and no haywire.
5	Liberator Assault Group Blood Angels	HARD	FAVOURED	+0.88	BA hammers/fists smash your no-invuln fight phase (the sim's worst matchup the other way).
5	Virulent Vectorium Death Guard	COIN-FLIP	EVEN	-0.20	Mortarion + Plague Marines, 5+++ and -1 Dmg army-wide.
5	Equatorial Hordes Orks	HARD	FAVOURED	+1.12	The horde pole — 100+ bodies you can't out-OC.
5	Lions of the Emperor Adeptus Custodes	FAVOURABLE	FAVOURED	+0.80	Same as Shield Host: so-few-models, out-OC and grind them off with volume.
5	Grand Coven Thousand Sons	COIN-FLIP	ATTRITION-NEGATIVE	-2.10	Rubric marines (2+, All Is Dust -1 Dmg) + Magnus + psychic Dev-Wounds that BYPASS invuln.
4	Peerless Bladesmen Emperor's Children	COIN-FLIP	FAVOURED	+1.05	Slaaneshi elite-melee (Lucius/Lord Exultant + Flawless Blades/Infractors).
4	Khorne Daemonkin World Eaters	HARD	FAVOURED	+0.76	Angron + Berzerkers + Eightbound melee blender.
4	Legion of Excess	COIN-FLIP	FAVOURED	+1.43	Keeper of Secrets + Fiends +

4	Freeblade Company Imperial Knights	COIN-FLIP	EVEN	-0.17	Mirror with more Armigers.
4	Mont'ka T'au Empire	UNFAVOURABLE → directional	HARD	-2.44	Mont'ka = forward/alpha T'au (extra move+shoot on the key turn).
4	Carnival of Excess Emperor's Children	COIN-FLIP → directional	FAVOURED	+1.16	Slaaneshi horde-lean (more bodies, Take-and-Hold).
4	Cabal of Chaos Chaos Space Marines	COIN-FLIP	FAVOURED	+0.88	Abaddon/Huron + Chosen/Terminators + Defiler.
4	Berzerker Warband World Eaters	HARD	FAVOURED	+1.09	Berzerker-heavy charge army.
4	Dread Mob Orks	COIN-FLIP	FAVOURED	+0.48	Walker/dakka (Kill Rig, Deffkoptas, big meks, rokkits).
4	Chaos Cult Chaos Space Marines	COIN-FLIP → horde-lean	FAVOURED	+0.50	Cultist bodies + Defilers + bikers.
4	Rubricae Phalanx Thousand Sons	COIN-FLIP	ATTRITION-NEGATIVE	-1.97	Rubric-heavy (2+/-1 Dmg bodies) + sorcerers.
3	Possessed Slaughterband World Eaters	HARD → directional	FAVOURED	+0.96	Possessed/daemon-engine melee.
3	More Dakka! Orks	COIN-FLIP	FAVOURED	+0.88	Tankbustas + Flash Gitz + Shokk Attack + Boyz.
3	War Horde Orks	HARD	FAVOURED	+1.36	Boyz-forward horde.
3	Champions of Contagion Death Guard	COIN-FLIP	EVEN	-0.23	Poxwalkers + Blight-haulers + Deathshroud + Lord of Contagion, 5++ + / -1 Dmg.
3	Shadowmark Talon Space Marines (Astartes)	COIN-FLIP → directional	FAVOURED	+0.71	Raven Guard infiltrate/stealth + jump-pack alpha (Shrike, Aethon Shaan, Incursors/Infiltrators).
3	Brandfast Oathband Leagues of Votann	COIN-FLIP	ATTRITION-NEGATIVE	-2.12	Land Fortress + Sagitaur + Hearthkyn + Thunderkyn.

3	Grizzled Company Astra Militarum	UNFAVOURABLE	FAVOURED	+1.07	Orders + Bullgryn wall + tanks/artillery/lascannon volume that chunks Questoris.
3	Aspect Host Aeldari	UNFAVOURABLE → directional	EVEN	-0.12	Fire Dragons (MELTA — delete a Knight) + Warp Spiders + Banshees + Avatar + Falcon.
3	Explorator Maniple Adeptus Mechanicus	UNFAVOURABLE	ATTRITION-NEGATIVE	-3.19	Kataphron Anti-Vehicle-4+ + Lethal bricks ≈ a dead Knight/turn, and they out-body you.
3	Biosanctic Broodsurge Genestealer Cult	COIN-FLIP	HARD	-0.61	Purestrains + Abominant + Ridgerunners + Neophyte/Acolyte horde, cult ambush.
3	Forgefather's Seekers Space Marines (Astartes)	COIN-FLIP	HARD	-0.47	Salamander flamer/melta durable + ERADICATORS + Storm Speeder Hammerstrike + Vulkan.
3	Saga of the Beastslayer Space Wolves	HARD	FAVOURED	+0.99	Wolf Guard Terminators + Arjac/Bjorn/Logan delivered by a Land Raider Redeemer.
3	Flyblown Host Death Guard	COIN-FLIP	HARD	-0.55	Blight-haulers + Plague Marines + Deathshroud + Bloat-Drones, 5+++/-1 Dmg.
3	Lords of Dread Chaos Knights	COIN-FLIP	FAVOURED	+0.72	Big-model mirror-ish — War Dogs + Abhorrent/Tyrant.
2	Pantheon of Woe Necrons	HARD / play-the-mission	FAVOURED	+0.88	Nightbringer + Void Dragon C'tan (un-killable: 4++, -1 Dmg, necrodermis return) + Tomb Blades/Scarabs.
2	Infernal Lance Chaos Knights	COIN-FLIP	EVEN	-0.11	War-Dog swarm lean.
2	Reclamation Force Space Marines (Astartes)	COIN-FLIP	FAVOURED	+1.19	Ballistus Dread + Bladeguard + ERADICATORS (melta — they delete a Knight) + Captain Titus.
2	Court of the Phoenician Emperor's Children	COIN-FLIP	FAVOURED	+0.95	Fulgrim + Infractors/Flawless Blades/Noise Marines.
2	Bridgehead Strike Astra Militarum	COIN-FLIP → directional	FAVOURED	+0.07	Tempestus Scions/Aquilons + Krieg deep-strike with melta/plasma.
2	Saga of the Great Wolf	HARD	FAVOURED	+1.11	Wolf Guard Terminators + Aggressors +

2	Stormlance Task Force Blood Angels	HARD	FAVOURED	+0.93	Sanguinary Guard + Death Company (jump packs) + Dante + Gladiator Lancer.
2	Gate Warden Lance Imperial Knights	COIN-FLIP	EVEN	+0.02	Armigers + Canis Rex + big knights, defensive lance.
2	Scintillating Legion Chaos Daemons	COIN-FLIP	HARD	-0.78	Lord of Change + Be'lakor + Horrors + Screammers.
2	Brotherhood Strike Grey Knights	COIN-FLIP → directional	FAVOURED	+0.96	Paladin/Terminator bricks (2+/4++/multi-W) + Dreadknight + psychic Dev-wounds + teleport.
2	Crusher Stampede Tyranids	COIN-FLIP	FAVOURED	+0.43	Norn Emissary/Assimilator + Tyrannofex + Hive Tyrant + Broodlord.
2	Bringers of Flame Adepta Sororitas	COIN-FLIP	FAVOURED	+0.37	Vahl + Paragons (melta HAMMER) + Immolators + Castigator + Dominions.
2	Synaptic Nexus Tyranids	COIN-FLIP	FAVOURED	+0.99	Norn Emissaries + Maleceptors + Zoanthropes + Swarmlord — psychic monster-mash.
2	Outlander Claw Genestealer Cult	COIN-FLIP → directional	HARD	-1.77	Ridgerunners + Jackals + Rockgrinder + Purestrains, fast ambush.
2	Obeisance Phalanx Necrons	HARD / play-the-mission	FAVOURED	+1.02	3× Monolith (T13 W22 2+, melta wounds on 5s) + Silent King + Imotekh.
2	Hypercrypt Legion Necrons	HARD → directional	FAVOURED	+0.93	Transcendent C'tan + Reanimator + Wraiths + hypercrypt teleport (redeploy anywhere).
2	Armoured Warhost Aeldari	COIN-FLIP	FAVOURED	+0.94	Fire Prisms (anti-tank — chunk Knights) + War Walkers + Farseer buffs (Guide/Doom re-rolls) + Fate dice.
2	Plague Legion Chaos Daemons	COIN-FLIP	EVEN	-0.34	Great Unclean One + Rotigus + Plaguebearers + Skull Cannon, FNP everywhere.
1	Cryptek Conclave Necrons	HARD / play-the-mission	FAVOURED	+0.40	C'tan Shard of the Deceiver (un-killable: 4++, -1 Dmg, return + it redeploys units) + Wraiths + Skorpekh.

1	Traitoris Lance Chaos Knights	COIN-FLIP	FAVOURED	+0.85	Knight Abominant (psychic dread big knight) + War Dog Karnivore/Huntsman swarm.
1	Shadow Legion Chaos Daemons	COIN-FLIP → directional	FAVOURED	+0.53	Be'lakor + 2× Bloodthirster + Plaguebearer/Nurgling chaff.
1	Firestorm Assault Force Dark Angels	COIN-FLIP	FAVOURED	+0.36	Land Raider + Hellblasters + Redemptor + Eradicators + Azrael + Storm Speeder Thunderstrike.
1	Hand of the Dynasty Necrons	HARD / play-the-mission	EVEN	-0.32	Nightbringer + Void Dragon C'tan (un-killable, -1 Dmg, 4++) + Warriors + Skorpekh + Lychguard.
1	Rad-Zone Corps Adeptus Mechanicus	UNFAVOURABLE	ATTRITION-NEGATIVE	-3.51	Rad-Zone = chip-MW/battle-shock (no Toughness reduction) + Onager/Skorpius/Kataphron anti-tank + Cawl.
1	Cohort Cybernetica Adeptus Mechanicus	UNFAVOURABLE	HARD	-2.96	Kastelan Robots + Kataphron bricks + Belisarius Cawl (buff engine) + Skorpius anti-tank.
1	Armoured Infantry Astra Militarum	UNFAVOURABLE	HARD	-0.80	Leman Russ + Hippogriff AFVs + Catachan bodies.
1	Seer Council Aeldari	COIN-FLIP	EVEN	+0.25	Eldrad + Warlock Conclave (Guide/Doom re-rolls + Fate dice) + Avatar/Fuegan + Fire Dragons (melta).
1	Bastion Task Force Black Templars	COIN-FLIP	FAVOURED	+1.12	Repulsor Executioners + Land Raider delivering Crusader/Sword Brethren melee.
1	Eldritch Raiders Aeldari	COIN-FLIP	FAVOURED	+0.79	Durable Wraithguard/Wraithblades (T-heavy) + Avatar + corsairs.
1	Armoured Trailblazers Leagues of Votann	COIN-FLIP	HARD	-0.48	Einhyr Hearthguard (deep-strike Anti-Vehicle MELEE maul) + Hearthkyn + Sagitaurs.
1	Hallowed Martyrs Adepta Sororitas	COIN-FLIP	HARD	-1.21	Vahl + Paragon Warsuits (buffed melta HAMMER) + Castigators + Sacresants.
1	Designation Force Astra Militarum	UNFAVOURABLE	FAVOURED	+0.31	A WALL of superheavy tanks (Shadowsword / Stormsword / Banesword / Banehammer).

1	Chaos Cult Chaos Daemons	COIN-FLIP	EVEN	-0.22	Bloodthirster + 2× Lord of Change + Great Unclean One + horrors — big monsters w/ FNP + Tzeentch psychic Dev-wounds.
1	Windrider Host Aeldari	UNFAVOURABLE → directional	HARD	-0.57	Windrider jetbike speed + Fire Dragon melta drops (Falcon-delivered).
1	Abhuman Auxiliaries Astra Militarum	COIN-FLIP	FAVOURED	+0.67	Baneblade/Stormlord superheavy tanks (big guns AND big targets your Volcano/thermal can one-shot) + Bullgryn wall + Leontus orders.
1	Subterranean Assault Tyranids	COIN-FLIP	FAVOURED	+1.17	Swarmlord + Old One Eye + Zoanthropes + Red Terror + Raveners, deep-strike/burrow alpha.
1	Final Day Genestealer Cult	COIN-FLIP	HARD	-0.43	Purestrains + Aberrants + Hyperadapted Raveners + Neophyte horde, cult ambush.
1	Goretrack Onslaught World Eaters	HARD	FAVOURED	+0.90	Angron + Berzerkers + Eightbound + Defiler.
1	Rollin' Deff Orks	COIN-FLIP	FAVOURED	+0.48	Wazdakka + Deffkoptas + Warbikers + Meganobz — fast Kult-of-Speed dakka + rokkit.
1	Lions of The Emperor Adeptus Custodes	FAVOURABLE	FAVOURED	+0.99	Same as the other Lions/Shield Host: elite-but-few (Allarus/Wardens/Telemon).
1	Penitent Host Adepta Sororitas	COIN-FLIP	FAVOURED	+0.73	Repentia + Arco-flagellants = high-S no-save glass melee (fights-first is the danger) behind the Triumph (Miracle-Dice engine).
1	Contagion Engines Death Guard	COIN-FLIP	FAVOURED	+0.54	Defiler + 3× Deathshroud Terminators + Lord of Contagion + Bloat-Drone, 5+ + +/-1 Dmg.
1	Canoptek Court Necrons	COIN-FLIP	HARD	-1.31	Canoptek Wraiths (fast, S-heavy melee, reanimate) + Doomsday Arks + Doomstalkers (big guns).
1	Fulguris Task Force Space Marines (Astartes)	COIN-FLIP	FAVOURED	+1.10	Repulsor Executioner + Repulsor + Bladeguard + Calgar + Storm Speeder Hammerstrike.
1	Combined Arms Astra Militarum	UNFAVOURABLE	HARD	-1.24	Basilisk indirect artillery + Hellhounds + Ogryns + Leontus orders.
1	Chaos Cult	COIN-FLIP	FAVOURED	+0.37	War Dog Karnivore/Brigand swarm —

Chaos Knights

small fast chaos knights.

1	Path of the Outcast Aeldari	COIN-FLIP → directional	FAVOURED	+1.32	Skyweavers + Troupe + Solitaire + Falcon — evasive glass melee.
1	Imperialis Fleet Imperial Agents	COIN-FLIP → directional	FAVOURED	+1.06	Vindicare/Callidus/Eversor assassins + Deathwatch/Aquila kill teams.
1	Dominus Foebreakers Imperial Knights	MIRROR	ATTRITION-NEGATIVE	-0.42	Knight mirror — Castellan + Valiant (short-range monster) + Helverins/Warglaives.
1	Hexwarp Thrallband Thousand Sons	COIN-FLIP	HARD	-0.92	Scarab Occult Terminators (2+/-1 Dmg) + 2× Daemon Prince of Tzeentch + Mutalith + Forgefiend.
1	Daemonic Incursion Chaos Daemons	COIN-FLIP	EVEN	+0.20	Be'lakor + Lord of Change + Kairos + Rotigus — psychic Dev-wound + Fate/re-rolls + FNP monsters.
1	Blade of Ultramar Space Marines (Astartes)	COIN-FLIP	FAVOURED	+0.45	Repulsor Executioner + Land Raider + Bladeguard + Gladiator Lancer + Calgar.
1	Kabalite Cartel Drukhari	COIN-FLIP	FAVOURED	+1.17	Incubi + Scourges w/ Heavy Weapons (dark lances = ANTI-TANK that chunks Knights) + Ravager + Kabalites.
1	Black Spear Task Force Deathwatch	COIN-FLIP → directional	FAVOURED	+0.70	Indomitor/Talonstrike Kill Teams (mixed elite marines, special-issue ammo = anti-everything) + Storm Speeder.
1	Mechanised Assault Astra Militarum	COIN-FLIP → directional	HARD	-0.81	Leontus + Kasrkin + Tempestus Scion drops.
1	Green Tide Orks	HARD	FAVOURED	+1.42	The hard counter: Ghaz + 100+ Boyz that come back.
1	Skitarii Hunter Cohort Adeptus Mechanicus	UNFAVOURABLE → directional	ATTRITION-NEGATIVE	-3.35	Ironstrider anti-tank + Skitarii speed + Cawl + a Callidus.
1	Da Big Hunt Orks	COIN-FLIP → HARD	FAVOURED	+1.05	Ghazghkull + Wazdakka + Beast Snagga/Boyz + Kill Rig.
1	Realspace Raiders Drukhari	COIN-FLIP	FAVOURED	+1.25	Scourges w/ Heavy Weapons + 2× Ravager = dark-lance anti-tank + Kabalite/Wrack bodies.
1	Godhammer Assault Force Black Templars	COIN-FLIP	FAVOURED	+1.15	3× Land Raider Redeemer (delivery) +

					Gladiator Lancers (anti-tank).
1	Augurium Task Force Grey Knights	COIN-FLIP → directional	FAVOURED	+0.69	2× Grand Master in Nemesis Dreadknight (big psychic monsters) + Paladins + Purifiers.
1	Host of Ascension Genestealer Cult	HARD	ATTRITION-NEGATIVE	-3.75	Mass Neophyte Hybrids + Acolytes = a body horde with cult ambush.

Runbooks — top 14 archetypes

Shield Host

Adeptus Custodes · 11 pilots · FAVOURABLE — out-OC + grind

How to play: Elite-but-FEW (W3-4, ~40 models). Out-OC (your OC10 vs their OC2) and grind their bodies with anti-infantry VOLUME (Avenger/RFBC/plasma). Volcano/thermal the Caladius + characters, NOT W3 Custodians (overkill). Lancer SWEEP (A10 S10) chews squads; target-rich for decapitation. Don't get greedy into their melee.

RUNBOOK — This List Tastes Like Death by Rock and Roll vs Adrian Perez — Adeptus Custodes / Shield Host

you play Destroyer's Wrath | they play Vital Link | deployment: crucible (120 games simulated)

READ: FAVOURED — you hold the board and out-last them; the game grinds your way.

WIN CONDITION: Grind: trade your durable bodies into theirs and sit on the objectives. Time is on your side.

POSTURE: play grind — advance and trade; you win the attrition on the objectives.

DEPLOYMENT: deploy centrally; push your durable bodies onto the mid-board objectives and trade forward.

BOARD CONTROL you vs them (avg objectives, R1->R5):

you : 0.6 1.1 0.8 1.0 0.9

them: 1.4 1.3 0.3 0.2 0.1

BOARD LYNCHPINS – who HOLDS the objectives (ANCHOR = durable, contest/out-position · SOFT = chaff, clear with volume):

```
- Custodian Guard      0C  40  5u @0C2  ANCHOR · hurts you
```

```
- Allarus Custodians          0C  36  3u @0C2  ANCHOR · hurts you
```

```
- Witchseekers          0C  10  2u @0C1  S0FT  · hurts you
```

(OC N = board total; '5u @OC2' = 5 units at OC2 per model; buffs/sticky in the how-to-play note)

PRIORITY KILLS (they hurt you AND you can remove them – kill in this order):

1. 5x Custodian Guard deals 21.0 w/turn to you, you remove it 92% of games

2. 3x Allarus Custodians deals 18.1 w/turn to you, you remove it 99% of games

3. Shield-Captain in Allarus Terminator Armour deals 6.6 w/turn to you, you remove it 98% of games

4. 2x Witchseekers deals 3.3 w/turn to you, you remove it 63% of games

PLAY AROUND (you CAN'T reliably remove these – screen / avoid / out-score, don't feed them):

(none – you can remove their key pieces)

YOUR WORKHORSES (do the damage – leverage + protect these):

- Cerastus Knight Lancer 30.3 w/turn, survives 1%
- 2x Knight Castellan 11.1 w/turn, survives 78%
- Knight Crusader 6.5 w/turn, survives 3%
- Armiger Warglaive 2.3 w/turn, survives 0%

YOUR LIABILITIES (die before earning their points – protect, hold back, or reconsider):

- Armiger Warglaive survives only 0%
- Navigator survives only 4%

SECONDARIES that pay here (score these when the matchup hands them to you):

- + No Prisoners
- + Overwhelming Force

- + Assassination (you can reach their characters)

- + Display of Might

- + Centre Ground

KEY STRATAGEMS this matchup: lean on your Valourstrike Lance defensive strats early, save CP for Counter-Offensive on their key charge.

THE TRAP: exposing Armiger Warglaive – it dies for nothing. Screen it or hold it back until it matters.

Valourstrike Lance

Imperial Knights · 11 pilots · MIRROR — the ditto

How to play: Knightball mirror (your own build). First turn + Rotate discipline decides it. Trade Volcano/plasma into their Questoris, Lancer hunts their Lancer/Castellan (Epic Challenge to snipe an attached char), win the secondary game. Don't lose a gun-Knight to their Lancer un-Rotated.

RUNBOOK — This List Tastes Like Death by Rock and Roll vs Alex Hernandez — Imperial Knights / Valourstrike Lance

you play Meatgrinder | they play Meatgrinder | deployment: short-edge
(120 games simulated)

READ: FAVOURED — you hold the board and out-last them; the game grinds your way.

WIN CONDITION: Grind: trade your durable bodies into theirs and sit on the objectives. Time is on your side.

POSTURE: play brace – meet the alpha from cover; counter-punch after their charge lands.

DEPLOYMENT: deploy BACK, in/behind cover near your primary – deny a turn-1 alpha and make them come to you; screen your home objectives (they'll try to get behind you).

BOARD CONTROL you vs them (avg objectives, R1->R5):

you : 0.8 0.8 0.9 0.8 0.7

them: 0.6 0.3 0.1 0.1 0.1

BOARD LYNCHPINS – who HOLDS the objectives (ANCHOR = durable, contest/out-position · SOFT = chaff, clear with volume):

- Canis Rex	OC 10 1u @OC10 ANCHOR · hurts you
- Cerastus Knight Atrapos	OC 10 1u @OC10 ANCHOR · hurts you
- Cerastus Knight Lancer	OC 10 1u @OC10 ANCHOR · hurts you
- Knight Castellan	OC 10 1u @OC10 ANCHOR · hurts you
- Knight Destrier	OC 8 1u @OC8 ANCHOR · hurts you

(OC N = board total; '5u @OC2' = 5 units at OC2 per model; buffs/sticky in the how-to-play note)

PRIORITY KILLS (they hurt you AND you can remove them – kill in this order):

1. Canis Rex 100% of games	deals 34.7 w/turn to you, you remove it
2. Cerastus Knight Atrapos of games	deals 31.4 w/turn to you, you remove it 96%
3. Cerastus Knight Lancer of games	deals 31.8 w/turn to you, you remove it 93%
4. Knight Destrier of games	deals 16.9 w/turn to you, you remove it 98%
5. Knight Castellan of games	deals 11.0 w/turn to you, you remove it 84%

PLAY AROUND (you CAN'T reliably remove these – screen / avoid / out-score, don't feed them):

(none – you can remove their key pieces)

YOUR WORKHORSES (do the damage – leverage + protect these):

- Cerastus Knight Lancer	38.0 w/turn, survives 8%
- 2x Knight Castellan	17.3 w/turn, survives 53%
- Knight Crusader	14.8 w/turn, survives 44%
- Armiger Warglaive	8.8 w/turn, survives 2%

YOUR LIABILITIES (die before earning their points – protect, hold back, or reconsider):

- Navigator survives only 0%

SECONDARIES that pay here (score these when the matchup hands them to you):

- + No Prisoners
- + Overwhelming Force
- + Bring It Down (you crack their big models)
- + Display of Might
- + Centre Ground

KEY STRATAGEMS this matchup: lean on your Valourstrike Lance defensive strats early, save CP for Counter-Offensive on their key charge.

THE TRAP: exposing Navigator – it dies for nothing. Screen it or hold it back until it matters.

[Librarius Conclave](#)

Space Marines (Astartes) · 10 pilots · COIN-FLIP → hard (kill the engine)

How to play: The Great Value engine: Dev-Wound Sternguard + Librarian Conclave discipline + Oath re-rolls stack a volley that IGNORES your invuln. KILL THE MULTIPLIER first (Librarian / re-roll or mark engine / Storm Speeder) — the naked bricks are chaff without it. Screen the alpha; don't cluster near a reactive shooter.

RUNBOOK – This List Tastes Like Death by Rock and Roll vs Aaron Rojas – Space Marines (Astartes) / Librarius Conclave

you play Destroyer's Wrath | they play Vital Link | deployment: crucible
(120 games simulated)

READ: HARD – you get OUT-CONTROLLED: they out-body you and hold more of the board where it counts.

WIN CONDITION: You can't out-body them – you must out-KILL to thin their scoring + deny objectives, or you lose the primary. Prioritise clearing the units ON the points, not the ones threatening you.

POSTURE: play grind – advance and trade; you win the attrition on the objectives.

DEPLOYMENT: deploy centrally; push your durable bodies onto the mid-board objectives and trade forward; screen your home objectives (they'll try to get behind you).

BOARD CONTROL you vs them (avg objectives, R1->R5):

you : 0.5 0.3 0.2 0.2 0.2

them: 2.4 1.4 1.2 1.0 0.7

BOARD LYNCHPINS – who HOLDS the objectives (ANCHOR = durable, contest/out-position · SOFT = chaff, clear with volume):

- Heavy Intercessor Squad OC 10 1u @OC2 SOFT · hurts you

- | | | | | | | |
|---------------------------|----|----|----|------|------|-------------|
| - Intercessor Squad | 0C | 10 | 1u | @0C2 | SOFT | · hurts you |
| - Infernus Squad | 0C | 10 | 2u | @0C1 | SOFT | · hurts you |
| - Aggressor Squad | 0C | 6 | 1u | @0C1 | SOFT | · hurts you |
| - Centurion Assault Squad | 0C | 6 | 1u | @0C2 | SOFT | · hurts you |

(OC N = board total; '5u @OC2' = 5 units at OC2 per model; buffs/sticky in the how-to-play note)

PRIORITY KILLS (they hurt you AND you can remove them – kill in this order):

- | | |
|--|---|
| 1. Intercessor Squad
of games | deals 42.4 w/turn to you, you remove it 91% |
| 2. Aggressor Squad
of games | deals 33.3 w/turn to you, you remove it 98% |
| 3. Terminator Squad
of games | deals 31.3 w/turn to you, you remove it 79% |
| 4. Centurion Assault Squad
of games | deals 9.4 w/turn to you, you remove it 100% |
| 5. Adrax Agatone
of games | deals 8.5 w/turn to you, you remove it 100% |

PLAY AROUND (you CAN'T reliably remove these – screen / avoid / out-score, don't feed them):

- Heavy Intercessor Squad survives 88%, deals 15.7 w/turn

YOUR WORKHORSES (do the damage – leverage + protect these): (they trade hard and die doing it – that's the plan here, keep them earning until they drop)

- Cerastus Knight Lancer 27.9 w/turn, survives 0%
- 2x Knight Castellan 15.6 w/turn, survives 25%
- Knight Crusader 8.3 w/turn, survives 4%
- Armiger Warglaive 4.6 w/turn, survives 0%

YOUR LIABILITIES (die before earning their points – protect, hold back, or reconsider):

- Navigator survives only 0%

SECONDARIES that pay here (score these when the matchup hands them to you):

- + No Prisoners
- + Overwhelming Force
- + Assassination (you can reach their characters)
- + Bring It Down (you crack their big models)

KEY STRATAGEMS this matchup: lean on your Valourstrike Lance defensive strats early, save CP for Counter-Offensive on their key charge.

THE TRAP: trying to KILL your way out of a body-count game – you can't clear enough of them. Kill only what's sitting ON the objectives and contest the rest; don't chase units that aren't scoring.

Cursed Legion

Necrons · 10 pilots · UNFAVOURABLE (~20-30%)

How to play: 54 Cold-Fervour Gauss (S7 AP-2 Lethal) + reanimation + out-OC, often an un-killable Void Dragon. Firepower-as-DENIAL: delete their soft OC to starve scoring, don't chase the un-killable. Accept the board loss, bank mobility secondaries, win on tempo not attrition.

RUNBOOK – This List Tastes Like Death by Rock and Roll vs AlanMichael Torres – Necrons / Cursed Legion and Skyshroud Spearhead

you play Meatgrinder | they play Meatgrinder | deployment: short-edge
(120 games simulated)

READ: FAVOURED – you hold the board and out-last them; the game grinds your way.

WIN CONDITION: Grind: trade your durable bodies into theirs and sit on the objectives. Time is on your side.

POSTURE: play brace – meet the alpha from cover; counter-punch after their charge lands.

DEPLOYMENT: deploy BACK, in/behind cover near your primary – deny a turn-1 alpha and make them come to you; screen your home objectives (they'll try to get behind you).

BOARD CONTROL you vs them (avg objectives, R1->R5):

you : 0.5 0.4 0.8 0.5 0.8

them: 1.2 1.5 0.7 0.4 0.2

BOARD LYNCHPINS – who HOLDS the objectives (ANCHOR = durable, contest/out-position · SOFT = chaff, clear with volume):

- Lokhust Destroyers OC 24 2u @OC2 SOFT · hurts you
- Canoptek Wraiths OC 12 1u @OC2 ANCHOR · hurts you
- Skorpekh Destroyers OC 12 1u @OC2 SOFT · hurts you
- Flayed Ones OC 10 2u @OC1 SOFT · hurts you
- Lokhust Heavy Destroyers OC 6 1u @OC2 SOFT · hurts you

(OC N = board total; '5u @OC2' = 5 units at OC2 per model; buffs/sticky in the how-to-play note)

PRIORITY KILLS (they hurt you AND you can remove them – kill in this order):

1. Skorpekh Destroyers deals 27.7 w/turn to you, you remove it 88% of games

2. C'tan Shard of the Nightbringer deals 11.6 w/turn to you, you remove it 100% of games

3. Canoptek Wraiths deals 14.3 w/turn to you, you remove it 72% of games

4. 2x Lokhust Destroyers of games	deals 16.8 w/turn to you, you remove it 58%
--------------------------------------	---

5. Skorpekh Lord of games	deals 9.0 w/turn to you, you remove it 92%
------------------------------	--

PLAY AROUND (you CAN'T reliably remove these – screen / avoid / out-score, don't feed them):

(none – you can remove their key pieces)

YOUR WORKHORSES (do the damage – leverage + protect these):

- Cerastus Knight Lancer	30.3 w/turn, survives 1%
- Knight Crusader	23.8 w/turn, survives 66%
- 2x Knight Castellan	16.8 w/turn, survives 69%
- Armiger Warglaive	13.8 w/turn, survives 12%

YOUR LIABILITIES (die before earning their points – protect, hold back, or reconsider):

- Navigator	survives only 1%
-------------	------------------

SECONDARIES that pay here (score these when the matchup hands them to you):

- + No Prisoners
- + Overwhelming Force
- + Assassination (you can reach their characters)
- + Bring It Down (you crack their big models)
- + Display of Might

KEY STRATAGEMS this matchup: lean on your Valourstrike Lance defensive strats early, save CP for Counter-Offensive on their key charge.

THE TRAP: exposing Navigator – it dies for nothing. Screen it or hold it back until it matters.

Awakened Dynasty

Necrons · 10 pilots · HARD / play-the-mission (triple-C'tan wall)

How to play: Un-killable: C'tan T11 W16 4++, -1 to incoming Damage, necrodermis return. You CANNOT table them. Remove the no-invuln support (Crypteks/lords) at range, out-tempo on secondaries, play the mission — never dump firepower into a C'tan.

RUNBOOK — This List Tastes Like Death by Rock and Roll vs David Self — Necrons / Awakened Dynasty

you play Unstoppable Force | they play Immovable Object | deployment:
short-edge (120 games simulated)

READ: FAVOURED — you hold the board and out-last them; the game grinds your way.

WIN CONDITION: Grind: trade your durable bodies into theirs and sit on the objectives. Time is on your side.

POSTURE: play brace – meet the alpha from cover; counter-punch after their charge lands.

DEPLOYMENT: deploy BACK, in/behind cover near your primary – deny a turn-1 alpha and make them come to you; screen your home objectives (they'll try to get behind you).

BOARD CONTROL you vs them (avg objectives, R1->R5):

```
you : 0.9 0.8 0.8 1.0 1.0
```

them: 1.7 1.3 0.8 0.3 0.1

BOARD LYNCHPINS – who HOLDS the objectives (ANCHOR = durable, contest/out-position · SOFT = chaff, clear with volume):

- Canoptek Wraiths 0C 24 2u @0C2 ANCHOR · hurts you

```
- Ophydian Destroyers      0C  12  2u  @0C2  SOFT  · hurts you
```

```
- Deathmarks          0C    5  1u @0C1  SOFT    · board-only
```

- C'tan Shard of the Nightbringer OC 4 1u @OC4 ANCHOR · hurts you

- C'tan Shard of the Void Dragon OC 4 1u @OC4 ANCHOR · hurts you

(OC N = board total; '5u @OC2' = 5 units at OC2 per model; buffs/sticky in the how-to-play note)

PRIORITY KILLS (they hurt you AND you can remove them – kill in this order):

1. C'tan Shard of the Nightbringer deals 24.5 w/turn to you, you remove it 100% of games

2. 2x Canoptek Wraiths deals 19.8 w/turn to you, you remove it 64% of games

3. C'tan Shard of the Void Dragon deals 10.3 w/turn to you, you remove it 100% of games

4. 2x Ophydian Destroyers deals 9.6 w/turn to you, you remove it 83% of games

5. Nekrosor Ammentar deals 4.9 w/turn to you, you remove it 100% of games

PLAY AROUND (you CAN'T reliably remove these – screen / avoid / out-score, don't feed them):

- Canoptek Scarab Swarms survives 67%, deals 9.9 w/turn

YOUR WORKHORSES (do the damage – leverage + protect these):

- Cerastus Knight Lancer 38.2 w/turn, survives 12%

- Knight Crusader 19.3 w/turn, survives 52%

- 2x Knight Castellan 16.6 w/turn, survives 80%

- Armiger Warglaive

9.9 w/turn, survives 7%

YOUR LIABILITIES (die before earning their points – protect, hold back, or reconsider):

- Navigator

survives only 6%

SECONDARIES that pay here (score these when the matchup hands them to you):

+ No Prisoners

+ Overwhelming Force

+ Assassination (you can reach their characters)

+ Bring It Down (you crack their big models)

+ Display of Might

KEY STRATAGEMS this matchup: lean on your Valourstrike Lance defensive strats early, save CP for Counter-Offensive on their key charge.

THE TRAP: exposing Navigator – it dies for nothing. Screen it or hold it back until it matters.

Assimilation Swarm

How to play: 5-Norn monster-mash w/ heal/regen + OC15 anchors. It's a KILL-RACE not an OC war (OC15 is unshiftable). Focus-kill the NO-INVULN pieces at range (Emissaries, Zoanthropes, Neurotyrant), grind the 4++ Assimilators, REFUSE the melee gang (kite M10-14), Lancer-assassinate a Norn (~21/charge). Win on kills + removing anchors.

RUNBOOK — This List Tastes Like Death by Rock and Roll vs Brandon Lucio — Tyranids / Assimilation Swarm

you play Unstoppable Force | they play Immovable Object | deployment: short-edge (120 games simulated)

READ: FAVOURED — you hold the board and out-last them; the game grinds your way.

WIN CONDITION: Grind: trade your durable bodies into theirs and sit on the objectives. Time is on your side.

POSTURE: play grind — advance and trade; you win the attrition on the objectives.

DEPLOYMENT: deploy centrally; push your durable bodies onto the mid-board objectives and trade forward; screen your home objectives (they'll try to get behind you).

BOARD CONTROL you vs them (avg objectives, R1->R5):

you : 0.8 1.0 1.1 1.1 1.2

them: 0.7 0.5 0.8 0.3 0.1

BOARD LYNCHPINS – who HOLDS the objectives (ANCHOR = durable, contest/out-position · SOFT = chaff, clear with volume):

- | | |
|--------------------|----------------------------------|
| - Norn Assimilator | OC 15 3u @OC5 ANCHOR · hurts you |
| - Zoanthropes | OC 5 1u @OC1 ANCHOR · hurts you |
| - Norn Emissary | OC 5 1u @OC5 ANCHOR · hurts you |
| - Neurotyrant | OC 3 1u @OC3 ANCHOR · hurts you |
| - The Red Terror | OC 3 1u @OC3 ANCHOR · hurts you |

(OC N = board total; '5u @OC2' = 5 units at OC2 per model; buffs/sticky in the how-to-play note)

PRIORITY KILLS (they hurt you AND you can remove them – kill in this order):

- | | |
|------------------------------------|---|
| 1. The Swarmlord
100% of games | deals 18.7 w/turn to you, you remove it |
| 2. The Red Terror
of games | deals 10.7 w/turn to you, you remove it 97% |
| 3. 3x Norn Assimilator
of games | deals 8.2 w/turn to you, you remove it 99% |
| 4. Norn Emissary
of games | deals 5.6 w/turn to you, you remove it 96% |
| 5. Neurotyrant
of games | deals 6.3 w/turn to you, you remove it 84% |

PLAY AROUND (you CAN'T reliably remove these – screen / avoid / out-score, don't feed them):

(none – you can remove their key pieces)

YOUR WORKHORSES (do the damage – leverage + protect these):

- Cerastus Knight Lancer 35.5 w/turn, survives 2%
- 2x Knight Castellan 25.5 w/turn, survives 89%
- Knight Crusader 22.4 w/turn, survives 77%
- Armiger Warglaive 5.0 w/turn, survives 1%

YOUR LIABILITIES (die before earning their points – protect, hold back, or reconsider):

- Navigator survives only 4%

SECONDARIES that pay here (score these when the matchup hands them to you):

- + No Prisoners
- + Overwhelming Force
- + Bring It Down (you crack their big models)
- + Display of Might

+ Centre Ground

KEY STRATAGEMS this matchup: lean on your Valourstrike Lance defensive strats early, save CP for Counter-Offensive on their key charge.

THE TRAP: exposing Navigator – it dies for nothing. Screen it or hold it back until it matters.

Coterie of the Conceited

Emperor's Children · 8 pilots · COIN-FLIP — concede Fulgrim

How to play: Fulgrim + fast Slaaneshi melee (re-roll charges, hits above weight). SCREEN/CONCEDE Fulgrim — don't feed the Lancer to him unless it's a clean one-round kill. Shoot the killable support, win Priority Assets on OC10, Lancer 4++ counter-charges the chaff melee. Don't get caught mid-board.

RUNBOOK — This List Tastes Like Death by Rock and Roll vs Ben O'Verbich — Emperor's Children / Coterie of the Conceited

you play Destroyer's Wrath | they play Vital Link | deployment: crucible
(120 games simulated)

READ: FAVOURED — you hold the board and out-last them; the game grinds your way.

WIN CONDITION: Grind: trade your durable bodies into theirs and sit on the objectives. Time is on your side.

POSTURE: play brace — meet the alpha from cover; counter-punch after their charge lands.

DEPLOYMENT: deploy BACK, in/behind cover near your primary – deny a turn-1 alpha and make them come to you; screen your home objectives (they'll try to get behind you).

BOARD CONTROL you vs them (avg objectives, R1->R5):

you : 0.8 1.2 1.2 1.0 0.8

them: 1.8 0.6 0.2 0.1 0.1

BOARD LYNCHPINS – who HOLDS the objectives (ANCHOR = durable, contest/out-position · SOFT = chaff, clear with volume):

- Infractors	OC 16 2u @OC2 SOFT · hurts you
- Tormentors	OC 16 2u @OC2 SOFT · hurts you
- Defiler	OC 10 2u @OC5 ANCHOR · hurts you
- Flawless Blades	OC 6 1u @OC1 SOFT · hurts you
- Fulgrim	OC 6 1u @OC6 ANCHOR · hurts you

(OC N = board total; '5u @OC2' = 5 units at OC2 per model; buffs/sticky in the how-to-play note)

PRIORITY KILLS (they hurt you AND you can remove them – kill in this order):

1. Fulgrim	deals 21.6 w/turn to you, you remove it
100% of games	

2. Flawless Blades of games	deals 16.4 w/turn to you, you remove it 99%
--------------------------------	---

3. 2x Tormentors of games	deals 15.8 w/turn to you, you remove it 90%
------------------------------	---

4. Maulerfiend 100% of games	deals 13.6 w/turn to you, you remove it
---------------------------------	---

5. 2x Defiler 100% of games	deals 10.2 w/turn to you, you remove it
--------------------------------	---

PLAY AROUND (you CAN'T reliably remove these – screen / avoid / out-score, don't feed them):

(none – you can remove their key pieces)

YOUR WORKHORSES (do the damage – leverage + protect these):

- Cerastus Knight Lancer	34.7 w/turn, survives 10%
- 2x Knight Castellan	16.8 w/turn, survives 65%
- Armiger Warglaive	12.6 w/turn, survives 8%
- Knight Crusader	11.7 w/turn, survives 27%

YOUR LIABILITIES (die before earning their points – protect, hold back, or reconsider):

- Navigator

survives only 0%

SECONDARIES that pay here (score these when the matchup hands them to you):

+ No Prisoners

+ Overwhelming Force

+ Assassination (you can reach their characters)

+ Bring It Down (you crack their big models)

+ Display of Might

KEY STRATAGEMS this matchup: lean on your Valourstrike Lance defensive strats early, save CP for Counter-Offensive on their key charge.

THE TRAP: exposing Navigator – it dies for nothing. Screen it or hold it back until it matters.

Retaliation Cadre

T'au Empire · 7 pilots · UNFAVOURABLE

How to play: Railgun Dev-Wounds + markerlight AP-volume + fusion; they fall-back-and-shoot and evasion neuters your melee. Kill the rail/fusion platforms EARLY (no invuln — your Volcano deletes them), deny the alpha strike, win the movement/mission game, don't rely on the charge.

RUNBOOK — This List Tastes Like Death by Rock and Roll vs Adrian Luna — T'au Empire / Retaliation Cadre

you play Meatgrinder | they play Meatgrinder | deployment: short-edge
(120 games simulated)

READ: HARD – you get OUT-CONTROLLED: they out-body you and hold more of the board where it counts.

WIN CONDITION: You can't out-body them – you must out-KILL to thin their scoring + deny objectives, or you lose the primary. Prioritise clearing the units ON the points, not the ones threatening you.

POSTURE: play hold – anchor the objectives; let their speed spend itself against your durability.

DEPLOYMENT: deploy BACK, in/behind cover near your primary – deny a turn-1 alpha and make them come to you; screen your home objectives (they'll try to get behind you).

BOARD CONTROL you vs them (avg objectives, R1->R5):

you : 0.1 1.1 0.6 0.4 0.5

them: 1.2 2.4 1.8 2.0 1.3

BOARD LYNCHPINS – who HOLDS the objectives (ANCHOR = durable, contest/out-position · SOFT = chaff, clear with volume):

- Pathfinder Team OC 20 2u @OC1 SOFT · hurts you
- Stealth Battlesuits OC 10 2u @OC1 SOFT · hurts you
- Crisis Fireknife Battlesuits OC 8 1u @OC2 SOFT · hurts you

- Crisis Starscythe Battlesuits 0C 8 1u @0C2 SOFT . hurts you

- Riptide Battlesuit 0C 8 2u @0C4 ANCHOR . hurts you

(0C N = board total; '5u @0C2' = 5 units at 0C2 per model; buffs/sticky in the how-to-play note)

PRIORITY KILLS (they hurt you AND you can remove them – kill in this order):

1. Commander Farsight deals 8.5 w/turn to you, you remove it 100%
of games

2. Broadside Battlesuits deals 8.1 w/turn to you, you remove it 82%
of games

3. The Twin Lance deals 4.2 w/turn to you, you remove it 98%
of games

4. Ghostkeel Battlesuit deals 3.5 w/turn to you, you remove it 92%
of games

5. 2x Riptide Battlesuit deals 3.5 w/turn to you, you remove it 78%
of games

PLAY AROUND (you CAN'T reliably remove these – screen / avoid / out-score, don't feed them):

- 2x Pathfinder Team survives 72%, deals 15.8 w/turn

- 2x Stealth Battlesuits survives 93%, deals 10.0 w/turn

- Crisis Fireknife Battlesuits survives 62%, deals 7.0 w/turn

- Crisis Starscythe Battlesuits survives 68%, deals 6.3 w/turn

YOUR WORKHORSES (do the damage – leverage + protect these):

- Cerastus Knight Lancer 36.7 w/turn, survives 2%
- Knight Crusader 28.9 w/turn, survives 54%
- 2x Knight Castellan 25.2 w/turn, survives 49%
- Armiger Warglaive 7.5 w/turn, survives 0%

YOUR LIABILITIES (die before earning their points – protect, hold back, or reconsider):

- Navigator survives only 0%

SECONDARIES that pay here (score these when the matchup hands them to you):

- + No Prisoners
- + Overwhelming Force
- + Assassination (you can reach their characters)
- + Bring It Down (you crack their big models)
- + Behind Enemy Lines

KEY STRATAGEMS this matchup: lean on your Valourstrike Lance defensive strats early, save CP for Counter-Offensive on their key charge.

THE TRAP: trying to KILL your way out of a body-count game – you can't clear enough of them. Kill only what's sitting ON the objectives and contest the rest; don't chase units that aren't scoring.

[Needgaârd Oathband](#)

Leagues of Votann · 7 pilots · COIN-FLIP — deny the drop

How to play: Deep-strike Berserk maul-swarm (Anti-Vehicle 3+ MELEE wounds you regardless of S) + ~2 Land Fortresses. DENY THE DROPS (screen every landing >9", Navigator Gaze bubble), kill the 2 Land Fortresses (no invuln), shred their W1 bodies. If the maul can't reach, you out-durable and out-shoot.

RUNBOOK — This List Tastes Like Death by Rock and Roll vs Andrew Johnson — Leagues of Votann / Needgaârd Oathband

you play Destroyer's Wrath | they play Vital Link | deployment: crucible (120 games simulated)

READ: EVEN / GRINDY — decided by the objective play and who commits better.

WIN CONDITION: Win the secondary + primary math; pick your fights, hold the middle, out-score.

POSTURE: play grind — advance and trade; you win the attrition on the objectives.

DEPLOYMENT: deploy centrally; push your durable bodies onto the mid-board objectives and trade forward; screen your home objectives (they'll try to get behind you).

BOARD CONTROL you vs them (avg objectives, R1->R5):

you : 0.9 1.1 0.5 0.4 0.3

them: 2.5 1.4 1.9 1.6 1.8

BOARD LYNCHPINS – who HOLDS the objectives (ANCHOR = durable, contest/out-position · SOFT = chaff, clear with volume):

- | | | | | | | |
|---------------------------------|----|----|----|------|------|-------------|
| - Ironkin Steeljacks with Heavy | 0C | 12 | 1u | @0C1 | SOFT | · hurts you |
| - Brôkhyr Thunderkyn | 0C | 12 | 2u | @0C1 | SOFT | · hurts you |
| - Hernkyn Pioneers | 0C | 12 | 2u | @0C2 | SOFT | · hurts you |
| - Hernkyn Yaegirs | 0C | 10 | 1u | @0C1 | SOFT | · hurts you |
| - Einhyr Hearthguard | 0C | 8 | 2u | @0C1 | SOFT | · hurts you |

(OC N = board total; '5u @OC2' = 5 units at OC2 per model; buffs/sticky in the how-to-play note)

PRIORITY KILLS (they hurt you AND you can remove them – kill in this order):

1. Hernkyn Yaegirs deals 20.0 w/turn to you, you remove it 63% of games
2. Ironkin Steeljacks with Melee Weapons deals 11.1 w/turn to you, you remove it 98% of games

- | | |
|--------------------------------------|---|
| 3. Buri Aegnirssen
of games | deals 7.9 w/turn to you, you remove it 100% |
| 4. 2x Einhyr Hearthguard
of games | deals 7.7 w/turn to you, you remove it 97% |
| 5. 2x Brôkhyn Thunderkyn
of games | deals 8.0 w/turn to you, you remove it 93% |

PLAY AROUND (you CAN'T reliably remove these – screen / avoid / out-score, don't feed them):

- Ironkin Steeljacks with Heavy Volkanite Disintegrators survives 92%, deals 78.2 w/turn

- 2x Hernkyn Pioneers survives 69%, deals 7.4 w/turn

- Kapricus Defenders survives 67%, deals 3.6 w/turn

YOUR WORKHORSES (do the damage – leverage + protect these): (they trade hard and die doing it – that's the plan here, keep them earning until they drop)

- Cerastus Knight Lancer 21.9 w/turn, survives 0%

- 2x Knight Castellan 18.1 w/turn, survives 26%

- Knight Crusader 17.5 w/turn, survives 17%

- Armiger Warglaive 5.9 w/turn, survives 1%

YOUR LIABILITIES (die before earning their points – protect, hold back, or reconsider):

- Navigator survives only 0%

SECONDARIES that pay here (score these when the matchup hands them to you):

- + No Prisoners
- + Overwhelming Force
- + Assassination (you can reach their characters)
- + Bring It Down (you crack their big models)
- + A Grievous Blow (anti-horde)

KEY STRATAGEMS this matchup: lean on your Valourstrike Lance defensive strats early, save CP for Counter-Offensive on their key charge.

THE TRAP: exposing Navigator – it dies for nothing. Screen it or hold it back until it matters.

Company of Hunters

Dark Angels · 7 pilots · UNFAVOURABLE (Ravenwing)

How to play: Catechism Dev-Wound plasma + Black Knight Anti-Vehicle melee + 90-bike out-OC on Disruption + they fall-back-and-shoot. KILL THE STORM SPEEDER THUNDERSTRIKE FIRST (its mark = +1 to wound your Knights). Deny drops, accept the OC loss, don't feed the Black Knights a clean charge.

RUNBOOK – This List Tastes Like Death by Rock and Roll vs Cam Hawkins – Dark Angels / Company of Hunters

you play Destroyer's Wrath | they play Vital Link | deployment: crucible
(120 games simulated)

READ: ATTRITION-NEGATIVE – they remove you faster than you remove them. Win on tempo, not kills.

WIN CONDITION: Score fast and early; do NOT get drawn into a straight trade you lose.

POSTURE: play hold – anchor the objectives; let their speed spend itself against your durability.

DEPLOYMENT: deploy BACK, in/behind cover near your primary – deny a turn-1 alpha and make them come to you; screen your home objectives (they'll try to get behind you).

BOARD CONTROL you vs them (avg objectives, R1->R5):

you : 0.7 0.2 0.2 0.0 0.0

them: 2.1 2.5 2.3 2.2 2.3

BOARD LYNCHPINS – who HOLDS the objectives (ANCHOR = durable, contest/out-position · SOFT = chaff, clear with volume):

- Ravenwing Black Knights OC 36 3u @OC2 SOFT · hurts you

- Ravenwing Command Squad OC 18 3u @OC2 SOFT · hurts you

- | | | | | | | |
|---------------------------|----|----|----|------|--------|--------------|
| - Inner Circle Companions | 0C | 12 | 1u | @0C2 | SOFT | · hurts you |
| - Land Speeder Vengeance | 0C | 9 | 3u | @0C3 | ANCHOR | · board-only |
| - Scout Squad | 0C | 5 | 1u | @0C1 | SOFT | · hurts you |

(0C N = board total; '5u @0C2' = 5 units at 0C2 per model; buffs/sticky in the how-to-play note)

PRIORITY KILLS (they hurt you AND you can remove them – kill in this order):

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1. 3x Ravenwing Command Squad
of games | deals 16.2 w/turn to you, you remove it 99% |
| 2. Scout Squad
of games | deals 17.7 w/turn to you, you remove it 63% |
| 3. Inner Circle Companions
100% of games | deals 10.6 w/turn to you, you remove it |
| 4. Lion El'Jonson
of games | deals 9.6 w/turn to you, you remove it 100% |
| 5. Sammael
of games | deals 7.7 w/turn to you, you remove it 100% |

PLAY AROUND (you CAN'T reliably remove these – screen / avoid / out-score, don't feed them):

- 2x Invader ATV survives 71%, deals 4.4 w/turn

YOUR WORKHORSES (do the damage – leverage + protect these): (they trade hard and die doing it – that's the plan here, keep them earning until they drop)

- Cerastus Knight Lancer 32.8 w/turn, survives 0%
- 2x Knight Castellan 17.1 w/turn, survives 5%
- Knight Crusader 10.8 w/turn, survives 1%
- Armiger Warglaive 3.3 w/turn, survives 0%

YOUR LIABILITIES (die before earning their points – protect, hold back, or reconsider):

- Navigator survives only 0%

SECONDARIES that pay here (score these when the matchup hands them to you):

- + No Prisoners
- + Overwhelming Force
- + Assassination (you can reach their characters)
- + Bring It Down (you crack their big models)
- + Behind Enemy Lines

KEY STRATAGEMS this matchup: lean on your Valourstrike Lance defensive strats early, save CP for Counter-Offensive on their key charge.

THE TRAP: exposing Navigator – it dies for nothing. Screen it or hold it back until it matters.

Wrath of the Rock

Dark Angels · 6 pilots · HARD — accept it (Deathwing wall)

How to play: Deathwing terminator bricks: 2+/4++, -1 Dmg, army-wide OC, NO decapitation target. This is the 31-98 hard-counter shape — you cannot out-body OR kill-race it (guns wrong-shaped, Lancer finds nothing to bite). Minimise the bleed, steal secondaries + tempo, accept the primary loss. Dodge if the draw allows.

RUNBOOK — This List Tastes Like Death by Rock and Roll vs AJ Garza — Dark Angels / Wrath of the Rock

you play Destroyer's Wrath | they play Vital Link | deployment: crucible (120 games simulated)

READ: HARD — you get OUT-CONTROLLED: they out-body you and hold more of the board where it counts.

WIN CONDITION: You can't out-body them — you must out-KILL to thin their scoring + deny objectives, or you lose the primary. Prioritise clearing the units ON the points, not the ones threatening you.

POSTURE: play grind — advance and trade; you win the attrition on the objectives.

DEPLOYMENT: deploy centrally; push your durable bodies onto the mid-board objectives and trade forward; screen your home objectives (they'll try to get behind you).

BOARD CONTROL you vs them (avg objectives, R1->R5):

you : 0.8 0.7 0.5 0.3 0.3

them: 2.7 1.5 1.3 1.2 1.0

BOARD LYNCHPINS – who HOLDS the objectives (ANCHOR = durable, contest/out-position · SOFT = chaff, clear with volume):

- Inner Circle Companions OC 12 1u @OC2 SOFT · hurts you
- Centurion Devastator Squad OC 12 2u @OC2 SOFT · hurts you
- Intercessor Squad OC 10 1u @OC2 SOFT · hurts you
- Heavy Intercessor Squad OC 10 1u @OC2 SOFT · hurts you
- Hellblaster Squad OC 10 1u @OC1 SOFT · hurts you

(OC N = board total; '5u @OC2' = 5 units at OC2 per model; buffs/sticky in the how-to-play note)

PRIORITY KILLS (they hurt you AND you can remove them – kill in this order):

1. Inner Circle Companions deals 44.6 w/turn to you, you remove it 99%
of games

2. Intercessor Squad deals 20.7 w/turn to you, you remove it 98%
of games

3. Deathwing Knights 100% of games	deals 16.4 w/turn to you, you remove it
4. Hellblaster Squad of games	deals 9.6 w/turn to you, you remove it 100%
5. Inceptor Squad of games	deals 13.7 w/turn to you, you remove it 68%

PLAY AROUND (you CAN'T reliably remove these – screen / avoid / out-score, don't feed them):

- Outrider Squad	survives 94%, deals 27.5 w/turn
- Heavy Intercessor Squad	survives 77%, deals 15.2 w/turn

YOUR WORKHORSES (do the damage – leverage + protect these):

- Cerastus Knight Lancer	26.5 w/turn, survives 1%
- 2x Knight Castellan	17.0 w/turn, survives 37%
- Knight Crusader	14.9 w/turn, survives 4%
- Armiger Warglaive	7.7 w/turn, survives 0%

YOUR LIABILITIES (die before earning their points – protect, hold back, or reconsider):

- Navigator	survives only 0%
-------------	------------------

SECONDARIES that pay here (score these when the matchup hands them to you):

- + No Prisoners
- + Overwhelming Force
- + Assassination (you can reach their characters)
- + A Grievous Blow (anti-horde)

KEY STRATAGEMS this matchup: lean on your Valourstrike Lance defensive strats early, save CP for Counter-Offensive on their key charge.

THE TRAP: trying to KILL your way out of a body-count game – you can't clear enough of them. Kill only what's sitting ON the objectives and contest the rest; don't chase units that aren't scoring.

Banishers

Grey Knights · 6 pilots · COIN-FLIP → directional (elite psychic TP)

How to play: Elite terminators (2+/4++/5W) + teleport + psychic Dev-Wounds (ignore invuln) + deep strike. Deny the drops (>9", Gaze bubble), out-OC the few bodies, spread vs psychic smite, focus casters. Directional — VERIFY at the table (new archetype, not yet play-tested vs Knights).

RUNBOOK — This List Tastes Like Death by Rock and Roll vs anthony martinez — Grey Knights / Banishers

you play Destroyer's Wrath | they play Vital Link | deployment: crucible
(120 games simulated)

READ: FAVOURED – you hold the board and out-last them; the game grinds your way.

WIN CONDITION: Grind: trade your durable bodies into theirs and sit on the objectives. Time is on your side.

POSTURE: play grind – advance and trade; you win the attrition on the objectives.

DEPLOYMENT: deploy centrally; push your durable bodies onto the mid-board objectives and trade forward.

BOARD CONTROL you vs them (avg objectives, R1->R5):

you : 1.1 1.2 1.4 0.9 0.8

them: 1.5 0.8 0.2 0.1 0.1

BOARD LYNCHPINS – who HOLDS the objectives (ANCHOR = durable, contest/out-position · SOFT = chaff, clear with volume):

```
- Strike Squad          0C  16  2u  @0C2  SOFT  .  hurts you
```

- Nemesis Dreadknight 0C 12 3u @0C4 ANCHOR · hurts you

```
- Paladin Squad          0C   9  1u @0C1  ANCHOR · hurts you
```

- Brotherhood Terminator Squad OC 6 1u @OC2 ANCHOR · hurts you

```
- Grand Master in Nemesis Dreadk OC 4 1u @OC4 ANCHOR · hurts you
```

(OC N = board total; '5u @OC2' = 5 units at OC2 per model; buffs/sticky in the how-to-play note)

PRIORITY KILLS (they hurt you AND you can remove them – kill in this order):

- | | |
|--|---|
| 1. Paladin Squad | deals 37.4 w/turn to you, you remove it |
| 100% of games | |
| 2. 2x Strike Squad | deals 16.2 w/turn to you, you remove it 95% |
| of games | |
| 3. 3x Nemesis Dreadknight | deals 13.5 w/turn to you, you remove it 96% |
| of games | |
| 4. Grand Master in Nemesis Dreadknight | deals 9.3 w/turn to you, you remove it |
| 97% of games | |
| 5. Brotherhood Terminator Squad | deals 7.3 w/turn to you, you remove it 98% |
| of games | |

PLAY AROUND (you CAN'T reliably remove these – screen / avoid / out-score, don't feed them):

(none – you can remove their key pieces)

YOUR WORKHORSES (do the damage – leverage + protect these):

- 2x Knight Castellan 17.0 w/turn, survives 77%
- Cerastus Knight Lancer 17.0 w/turn, survives 0%

- Knight Crusader 11.9 w/turn, survives 30%
- Armiger Warglaive 9.8 w/turn, survives 8%

YOUR LIABILITIES (die before earning their points – protect, hold back, or reconsider):

- Navigator survives only 0%

SECONDARIES that pay here (score these when the matchup hands them to you):

- + No Prisoners
- + Overwhelming Force
- + Assassination (you can reach their characters)
- + Bring It Down (you crack their big models)
- + Display of Might

KEY STRATAGEMS this matchup: lean on your Valourstrike Lance defensive strats early, save CP for Counter-Offensive on their key charge.

THE TRAP: exposing Navigator – it dies for nothing. Screen it or hold it back until it matters.

Experimental Prototype Cadre

T'au Empire · 6 pilots · UNFAVOURABLE

How to play: As Retaliation — railgun Dev-Wounds + markerlight stacking. Prototype wargear = extra range/AP; kill the marker/rail platforms first, minimise firing angles into your Questoris, out-position.

RUNBOOK — This List Tastes Like Death by Rock and Roll vs Brandon Sullivan —
T'au Empire / Experimental Prototype Cadre

you play Unstoppable Force | they play Immovable Object | deployment:
short-edge (120 games simulated)

READ: FAVOURED — you hold the board and out-last them; the game grinds your way.

WIN CONDITION: Grind: trade your durable bodies into theirs and sit on the objectives. Time is on your side.

POSTURE: play turtle — hold your half from cover; make them walk into you — don't over-extend.

DEPLOYMENT: deploy BACK, in/behind cover near your primary — deny a turn-1 alpha and make them come to you; screen your home objectives (they'll try to get behind you).

BOARD CONTROL you vs them (avg objectives, R1->R5):

you : 1.6 0.8 0.9 1.0 1.2

them: 1.6 1.9 1.2 0.4 0.1

BOARD LYNCHPINS – who HOLDS the objectives (ANCHOR = durable, contest/out-position · SOFT = chaff, clear with volume):

- Kroot Carnivores	0C 80 4u @0C2 SOFT · hurts you
- Krootox Rampagers	0C 36 3u @0C2 SOFT · hurts you
- Vespids Stingwings	0C 30 3u @0C1 SOFT · hurts you
- Kroot Farstalkers	0C 21 1u @0C1 SOFT · hurts you
- Krootox Riders	0C 8 2u @0C2 SOFT · hurts you

(0C N = board total; '5u @0C2' = 5 units at 0C2 per model; buffs/sticky in the how-to-play note)

PRIORITY KILLS (they hurt you AND you can remove them – kill in this order):

1. Kroot Farstalkers of games	deals 40.1 w/turn to you, you remove it 93%
2. 3x Krootox Rampagers of games	deals 25.5 w/turn to you, you remove it 88%
3. 2x Krootox Riders of games	deals 17.5 w/turn to you, you remove it 81%
4. 4x Kroot Carnivores of games	deals 11.1 w/turn to you, you remove it 99%
5. Kroot Hounds of games	deals 5.6 w/turn to you, you remove it 92%

PLAY AROUND (you CAN'T reliably remove these – screen / avoid / out-score, don't feed them):

(none – you can remove their key pieces)

YOUR WORKHORSES (do the damage – leverage + protect these):

- Knight Crusader 28.8 w/turn, survives 95%
- Cerastus Knight Lancer 28.0 w/turn, survives 5%
- 2x Knight Castellan 18.8 w/turn, survives 82%
- Navigator 2.8 w/turn, survives 1%

YOUR LIABILITIES (die before earning their points – protect, hold back, or reconsider):

- | | |
|---------------------|------------------|
| - Armiger Warglaive | survives only 0% |
| - Navigator | survives only 1% |

SECONDARIES that pay here (score these when the matchup hands them to you):

- + No Prisoners
- + Overwhelming Force
- + Assassination (you can reach their characters)

+ A Grievous Blow (anti-horde)

+ Display of Might

KEY STRATAGEMS this matchup: lean on your Valourstrike Lance defensive strats early, save CP for Counter-Offensive on their key charge.

THE TRAP: exposing Armiger Warglaive – it dies for nothing. Screen it or hold it back until it matters.

Vanguard Onslaught

Tyranids · 6 pilots · COIN-FLIP → directional (fast infiltrators)

How to play: Recon-disposition speed/infiltrate build — they out-tempo and grab early. Screen your deployment (deny infiltrate/scout charges >9"), kill what scores, don't over-extend a gun-Knight. Directional read — verify at the table.

RUNBOOK — This List Tastes Like Death by Rock and Roll vs Christopher Deam — Tyranids / Vanguard Onslaught

you play Consecrate | they play Triangulation | deployment: long-edge
(120 games simulated)

READ: FAVOURED — you hold the board and out-last them; the game grinds your way.

WIN CONDITION: Grind: trade your durable bodies into theirs and sit on the objectives. Time is on your side.

POSTURE: play grind — advance and trade; you win the attrition on the objectives.

DEPLOYMENT: deploy centrally; push your durable bodies onto the mid-board objectives and trade forward.

BOARD CONTROL you vs them (avg objectives, R1->R5):

you : 0.0 1.0 1.1 1.3 1.1

them: 1.6 1.0 0.6 0.2 0.1

BOARD LYNCHPINS – who HOLDS the objectives (ANCHOR = durable, contest/out-position · SOFT = chaff, clear with volume):

- Genestealers	OC	20	2u @OC1	SOFT	· hurts you
- Norn Emissary	OC	10	2u @OC5	ANCHOR	· hurts you
- Von Ryan's Leapers	OC	6	2u @OC1	SOFT	· hurts you
- Norn Assimilator	OC	5	1u @OC5	ANCHOR	· hurts you
- The Swarmlord	OC	3	1u @OC3	ANCHOR	· hurts you

(OC N = board total; '5u @OC2' = 5 units at OC2 per model; buffs/sticky in the how-to-play note)

PRIORITY KILLS (they hurt you AND you can remove them – kill in this order):

1. 2x Genestealers	deals 19.1 w/turn to you, you remove it 86% of games
--------------------	--

2. Norn Assimilator 100% of games	deals 11.1 w/turn to you, you remove it
3. 2x Norn Emissary of games	deals 8.9 w/turn to you, you remove it 94%
4. 2x Von Ryan's Leapers of games	deals 10.2 w/turn to you, you remove it 82%
5. The Swarmlord of games	deals 7.8 w/turn to you, you remove it 100%

PLAY AROUND (you CAN'T reliably remove these – screen / avoid / out-score, don't feed them):

(none – you can remove their key pieces)

YOUR WORKHORSES (do the damage – leverage + protect these):

- Cerastus Knight Lancer	39.3 w/turn, survives 13%
- Knight Crusader	19.0 w/turn, survives 80%
- 2x Knight Castellan	16.7 w/turn, survives 80%
- Armiger Warglaive	13.3 w/turn, survives 9%

YOUR LIABILITIES (die before earning their points – protect, hold back, or reconsider):

- Navigator

survives only 11%

SECONDARIES that pay here (score these when the matchup hands them to you):

+ No Prisoners

+ Overwhelming Force

+ Assassination (you can reach their characters)

+ Bring It Down (you crack their big models)

+ Display of Might

KEY STRATAGEMS this matchup: lean on your Valourstrike Lance defensive strats early, save CP for Counter-Offensive on their key charge.

THE TRAP: exposing Navigator — it dies for nothing. Screen it or hold it back until it matters.

Rest of the field — how-to-play

Librarius Conclave **COIN-FLIP → hard**

Dark Angels · 5 pilots · sim FAVOURED

As the SM Conclave — Dev-Wound plasma/Sternguard + psychic buffs that bypass invuln. Kill the buff/psychic engine first; spread vs Dev-wound smite; deny the alpha.

Skysplinter Assault **FAVOURABLE**

Drukhari · 5 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Their Lethal/Decapitating keywords are NON-Vehicle → they don't touch your Knights, and no haywire. Out-durable and win the attrition. Only risk = losing Reconnaissance TEMPO — don't let them free-score; contest the board, kill the raiders (W-fragile).

Liberator Assault Group **HARD**

Blood Angels · 5 pilots · sim FAVOURED

BA hammers/fists smash your no-invuln fight phase (the sim's worst matchup the other way). SHOOT THEM OFF BEFORE THE CHARGE, Lancer 4++ is your only melee answer, screen + kite the Death Company / Sanguinary hammer. Never let a

gun-Knight get charged; win at range or not at all.

Virulent Vectorium **COIN-FLIP**

Death Guard · 5 pilots · sim EVEN

Mortarion + Plague Marines, 5+++ and -1 Dmg army-wide. Don't grind into the FNP wall — out-tempo, remove what you can at range, play the mission. Mortarion is a Lancer target (T12 monster) but tanky; only commit for a clean kill.

Equatorial Hordes **HARD**

Orks · 5 pilots · sim FAVOURED

The horde pole — 100+ bodies you can't out-OC. Anti-infantry VOLUME into the blobs (Avenger/RFBC), kill what's ON the objectives, don't chase. Accept the OC loss, win secondaries where possible. Green-Tide-adjacent = known bad matchup.

Lions of the Emperor **FAVOURABLE**

Adeptus Custodes · 5 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Same as Shield Host: so-few-models, out-OC and grind them off with volume. Watch Martial Ka'tah stances in melee — stay at range, refuse the gang. Lancer sweeps their squads; Volcano the Caladius/characters, not W3 bodies.

Grand Coven **COIN-FLIP**

Thousand Sons · 5 pilots · sim ATTRITION-NEGATIVE

Rubric marines (2+, All Is Dust -1 Dmg) + Magnus + psychic Dev-Wounds that BYPASS invuln. Magnus = a Lancer decapitation target (big monster, but warded — commit only for the kill). Kill the psychic buff/caster engine, spread vs Dev-wound smite, grind the Rubrics with high-Dmg guns (their -1 Dmg blunts multi-dmg).

Peerless Bladesmen **COIN-FLIP**

Emperor's Children · 4 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Slaaneshi elite-melee (Lucius/Lord Exultant + Flawless Blades/Infractors). Same plan: shoot the killable multipliers, refuse the melee trade you don't want, Lancer counters, win on OC/secondaries. Fast — screen your backfield.

Khorne Daemonkin **HARD**

World Eaters · 4 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Angron + Berzerkers + Eightbound melee blender. SHOOT ON THE WAY IN, Lancer 4++ counter, screen + kite — never get charged in bulk. Angron is a Lancer target but returns; don't over-invest, just deny the charge and out-shoot.

Legion of Excess **COIN-FLIP**

Chaos Daemons · 4 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Keeper of Secrets + Fiends + Daemonettes — fast, fights-first melee. Screen the charge lanes, shoot the Keepers (big monster, but 4++ — commit guns not a wasted Lancer), out-durable the fragile Daemonettes. Don't get caught mid-board; Lancer counters a lead daemon.

Freeblade Company **COIN-FLIP**

Imperial Knights · 4 pilots · sim EVEN

Mirror with more Armigers. Volume-kill their Armigers, Lancer hunts their big knights (Castellan/Destrier/Paladin), Rotate the focused Knight, first turn decides it. Out-activate carefully — more small knights = more of their activations.

Mont'ka **UNFAVOURABLE → directional**

T'au Empire · 4 pilots · sim HARD

Mont'ka = forward/alpha T'au (extra move+shoot on the key turn). Weather the aggressive turn from cover, then punish the exposed suits with your guns. Kill fusion/rail first. Directional — verify.

Carnival of Excess **COIN-FLIP → directional**

Emperor's Children · 4 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Slaaneshi horde-lean (more bodies, Take-and-Hold). Anti-infantry volume into the blades, out-durable, hold objectives on OC10. Directional — verify the exact build.

Cabal of Chaos **COIN-FLIP**

Chaos Space Marines · 4 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Abaddon/Huron + Chosen/Terminators + Defiler. WATCH DARK PACTS — they buy Lethal/Dev on demand (invuln-negation). Defiler = Volcano target; Chosen/Terminators die to AP volume; Abaddon/Huron are tough (Lancer only for a clean kill). Kill the buff characters, screen the alpha.

Berzerker Warband **HARD**

World Eaters · 4 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Berzerker-heavy charge army. Same plan: kill on the approach, screen the charge lanes, Lancer counters the lead brick, kite the rest. Win at range or lose the fight phase.

Dread Mob **COIN-FLIP**

Orks · 4 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Walker/dakka (Kill Rig, Deffkoptas, big meks, rokkits). Their rokkits pop your Armigers — keep them back. Trade guns, kill the anti-tank platforms, out-durable the shooting; fewer bodies than a horde so OC is winnable.

Chaos Cult **COIN-FLIP → horde-lean**

Chaos Space Marines · 4 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Cultist bodies + Defilers + bikers. Anti-infantry VOLUME into the cultists, Volcano the Defilers, out-durable; don't get out-OC'd by the chaff — kill what's on the points. Watch Dark Pacts on the Legionaries/Chosen.

Rubricae Phalanx **COIN-FLIP**

Thousand Sons · 4 pilots · sim ATTRITION-NEGATIVE

Rubric-heavy (2+/-1 Dmg bodies) + sorcerers. Same as Grand Coven: kill the casters/buff engine, use high-Dmg guns into the -1-Dmg Rubrics, spread vs Dev-wound smite. Out-OC where you can — Rubrics are low model-count.

Possessed Slaughterband **HARD → directional**

World Eaters · 3 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Possessed/daemon-engine melee. Shoot before the charge, Lancer 4+ +, screen. Directional — verify the engines (Lord of Skulls / daemon engines are Volcano targets).

More Dakka! **COIN-FLIP**

Orks · 3 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Tankbustas + Flash Gitz + Shokk Attack + Boyz. Their rokkit/Tankbustas threaten your Armigers + Questoris — KILL THE TANKBUSTAS/FLASH GITZ first (their anti-tank), out-durable the dakka. Fewer bodies than a horde so OC is winnable; keep Armigers out of rokkit range.

War Horde **HARD**

Orks · 3 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Boyz-forward horde. Same as Equatorial: out-bodied, can't out-OC. Volume into the blobs, hold what you can, bank secondaries, accept the primary deficit.

Champions of Contagion **COIN-FLIP**

Death Guard · 3 pilots · sim EVEN

Poxwalkers + Blight-haulers + Deathshroud + Lord of Contagion, 5+++ / -1 Dmg. Don't grind into the FNP; kill the Myphitic Blight-haulers (their anti-tank) at range, out-tempo, play the mission. Deathshroud are a nasty counter-charge — don't feed a gun-Knight.

Shadowmark Talon **COIN-FLIP → directional**

Space Marines (Astartes) · 3 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Raven Guard infiltrate/stealth + jump-pack alpha (Shrike, Aethon Shaan, Incursors/Infiltrators). SCREEN your deployment to deny infiltrate/scout charges >9", weather the jump alpha, out-shoot. Watch a marked-target buff. Directional — verify at the table.

Brandfast Oathband **COIN-FLIP**

Leagues of Votann · 3 pilots · sim ATTRITION-NEGATIVE

Land Fortress + Sagitaur + Hearthkyn + Thunderkyn. Judgement tokens = re-roll wound + AP vs a marked unit (invuln-negation risk). Kill the Land Fortress + Thunderkyn (anti-tank), deny the judgement stack on a key Knight, out-durable; fewer bodies than Needgaa'd so OC is winnable.

Grizzled Company **UNFAVOURABLE**

Astra Militarum · 3 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Orders + Bullgryn wall + tanks/artillery/lascannon volume that chunks Questoris. Kill the tanks/artillery/Hellhound early, weather the volume from cover, grind the infantry — but they out-body you on OC. Bank secondaries; don't over-expose a Knight to massed lascannon.

Aspect Host **UNFAVOURABLE → directional**

Aeldari · 3 pilots · sim EVEN

Fire Dragons (MELTA — delete a Knight) + Warp Spiders + Banshees + Avatar + Falcon. KILL THE FIRE DRAGONS before they reach melta range (screen the Falcon delivery), evasion neuters your melee, they out-tempo. Avatar = a Lancer target. Expect a tempo loss; win where the guns can catch them.

Explorator Maniple **UNFAVOURABLE**

Adeptus Mechanicus · 3 pilots · sim ATTRITION-NEGATIVE

Kataphron Anti-Vehicle-4+ + Lethal bricks ≈ a dead Knight/turn, and they out-body you. Kill the Kataphron bricks first (they're the anti-tank), deny the alpha, don't get out-scored — bank secondaries, respect the loss.

Biosanctic Broodsurge **COIN-FLIP**

Genestealer Cult · 3 pilots · sim HARD

Purestrains + Abominant + Ridgerunners + Neophyte/Acolyte horde, cult ambush. DENY the ambush (screen every drop >9"), anti-infantry volume into the bodies, Lancer counters the Purestrains. Watch the return/re-deploy; kill what scores, don't chase.

Forgefather's Seekers **COIN-FLIP**

Space Marines (Astartes) · 3 pilots · sim HARD

Salamander flamer/melta durable + ERADICATORS + Storm Speeder Hammerstrike + Vulkan. Kill the Eradicators (melta anti-tank) + Storm Speeder (anti-tank/buff) first, out-durable the flamers, trade guns. Vulkan buffs their melta — priority to remove the melta package.

Saga of the Beastslayer **HARD**

Space Wolves · 3 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Wolf Guard Terminators + Arjac/Bjorn/Logan delivered by a Land Raider Redeemer. SHOOT THE LAND RAIDER before it disgorges (Volcano), Lancer counters the lead brick, screen + kite. Their characters hit like trucks in melee — never get a gun-Knight charged.

Flyblown Host **COIN-FLIP**

Death Guard · 3 pilots · sim HARD

Blight-haulers + Plague Marines + Deathshroud + Bloat-Drones, 5+++/1 Dmg. Kill the Blight-haulers/Bloat-Drones (anti-tank) at range, don't grind into the FNP, out-tempo + play the mission. Deathshroud counter-charge — screen your gun-Knights.

Lords of Dread **COIN-FLIP**

Chaos Knights · 3 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Big-model mirror-ish — War Dogs + Abhorrent/Tyrant. It's a Knight duel: Lancer hunts their big knights/war dogs, Rotate discipline vs their guns, first turn matters. Trade Volcano into their Questoris; watch dread abilities (fear/MW).

Pantheon of Woe **HARD / play-the-mission**

Necrons · 2 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Nightbringer + Void Dragon C'tan (un-killable: 4++ , -1 Dmg, necrodermis return) + Tomb Blades/Scarabs. Can't table the C'tan — kill the no-invuln soft OC (Tomb Blades/Scarabs), out-tempo on secondaries, play the mission. Never dump guns into a C'tan.

Infernal Lance **COIN-FLIP**

Chaos Knights · 2 pilots · sim EVEN

War-Dog swarm lean. More small knights = out-activation risk; Lancer + Volcano pick off war dogs, Rotate the focused Knight, hold OC10 objectives. Knight duel — first turn + target priority decide it.

Reclamation Force **COIN-FLIP**

Space Marines (Astartes) · 2 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Ballistus Dread + Bladeguard + ERADICATORS (melta — they delete a Knight) + Captain Titus. Eradicators are the #1 priority kill (no invuln, your Volcano/volume removes them), then the Ballistus. Out-durable the rest, trade guns; don't cluster a Knight in melta range.

Court of the Phoenician **COIN-FLIP**

Emperor's Children · 2 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Fulgrim + Infractors/Flawless Blades/Noise Marines. Screen/concede Fulgrim, shoot the killable support, win Priority Assets on OC10, Lancer 4++ counters the chaff melee. Fast — protect your backfield.

Bridgehead Strike **COIN-FLIP → directional**

Astra Militarum · 2 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Tempestus Scions/Aquilons + Krieg deep-strike with melta/plasma. DENY THE DROPS (screen >9", Gaze bubble), weather the alpha, then shred the droppers — they're T3 W1, volume deletes them once landed. Punish as they expose.

Saga of the Great Wolf **HARD**

Space Wolves · 2 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Wolf Guard Terminators + Aggressors + Arjac/Bjorn/Logan. As Beastslayer — shoot the delivery/lead brick before the charge, Lancer counter, screen + kite. Logan/Arjac wreck a gun-Knight in melee; win at range.

Stormlance Task Force **HARD**

Blood Angels · 2 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Sanguinary Guard + Death Company (jump packs) + Dante + Gladiator Lancer. BA jump-hammer smashes your fight phase — SHOOT THEM OFF before the charge, Lancer 4++ counters the lead brick, screen + kite; kill the Gladiator Lancer (anti-tank). Never let a gun-Knight get charged.

Gate Warden Lance **COIN-FLIP**

Imperial Knights · 2 pilots · sim EVEN

Armigers + Canis Rex + big knights, defensive lance. Knight duel — Lancer hunts their big knights, volume-kills Armigers, Rotate the focused Knight. Canis Rex is a tough character-knight (Sir Hekhtur pilot ejects) — don't over-commit the Lancer into it.

Scintillating Legion **COIN-FLIP**

Chaos Daemons · 2 pilots · sim HARD

Lord of Change + Be'lakor + Horrors + Screemers. Dev-wound smite BYPASSES your invuln — KILL THE CASTERS (Lord of Change/Be'lakor are ward 4++ , commit guns for a clean kill), spread vs smite, anti-infantry into the Horrors. Watch Be'lakor's shadow debuffs.

Brotherhood Strike **COIN-FLIP → directional**

Grey Knights · 2 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Paladin/Terminator bricks (2+/4++/multi-W) + Dreadknight + psychic Dev-wounds + teleport. Deny the drops (>9"), out-

OC the few bodies, spread vs smite, focus the casters. High-quality but low-count — grind them. Directional — verify.

Crusher Stampede **COIN-FLIP**

Tyrannids · 2 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Norn Emissary/Assimilator + Tyrannofex + Hive Tyrant + Broodlord. Kill-race, not OC. Volcano the NO-INVULN Norn Emissary + Tyrannofex at range, Lancer-assassinate a Norn (~21/charge), refuse the melee gang (kite), grind the 4++ Assimilators. Win on kills + anchors removed.

Bringers of Flame **COIN-FLIP**

Adepta Sororitas · 2 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Vahl + Paragons (melta HAMMER) + Immolators + Castigator + Dominions. Their buffed melta is REAL anti-tank that chunks Knights — KILL VAHL+PARAGONS and the melta Dominions first (Paragons T7 2+/4++; the girls are T3 W1, volume shreds them). Watch Miracle Dice on a key save/wound. Out-durable once the melta's gone.

Synaptic Nexus **COIN-FLIP**

Tyrannids · 2 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Norn Emissaries + Maleceptors + Zoanthropes + Swarmlord — psychic monster-mash. Volcano the NO-INVULN Norn Emissaries + Maleceptors at range, spread vs psychic smite/Dev, Lancer-assassinate a Norn, refuse the melee gang. Kill-race + remove anchors.

Outlander Claw **COIN-FLIP → directional**

Genestealer Cult · 2 pilots · sim HARD

Ridgerunners + Jackals + Rockgrinder + Purestrains, fast ambush. Deny the ambush (>9"), kill the Rockgrinder/Ridgerunners (their punch), anti-infantry into the horde, Lancer counters Purestrains. They out-tempo — contest, don't chase. Directional.

Obeisance Phalanx **HARD / play-the-mission**

Necrons · 2 pilots · sim FAVOURED

3× Monolith (T13 W22 2+, melta wounds on 5s) + Silent King + Imotekh. The Monoliths are near-un-killable AND deep-strike anchors — do NOT over-invest guns cracking them; kill the softer scoring pieces, out-manoeuve (they're slow), play Disruption-style tempo. A removal/mission game, not attrition.

Hypercrypt Legion **HARD → directional**

Necrons · 2 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Transcendent C'tan + Reanimator + Wraiths + hypercrypt teleport (redeploy anywhere). Deny the drops, can't kill the C'tan — play the mission, remove no-invuln support, out-tempo. Directional — verify the teleport shenanigans.

Armoured Warhost **COIN-FLIP**

Aeldari · 2 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Fire Prisms (anti-tank — chunk Knights) + War Walkers + Farseer buffs (Guide/Doom re-rolls) + Fate dice. KILL THE FIRE PRISMS + FARSEER (the buff/anti-tank engine), out-durable the rest; watch Fate dice on a key save and their evasion. Trade guns, win on durability.

Plague Legion **COIN-FLIP**

Chaos Daemons · 2 pilots · sim EVEN

Great Unclean One + Rotigus + Plaguebearers + Skull Cannon, FNP everywhere. Volcano the GUO/Rotigus (big, tanky, 5++ — commit real guns), anti-infantry into the Plaguebearers, out-tempo; don't grind into the FNP horde. Win on tempo/secondaries, not attrition.

Cryptek Conclave **HARD / play-the-mission**

Necrons · 1 pilots · sim FAVOURED

C'tan Shard of the Deceiver (un-killable: 4++, -1 Dmg, return + it redeploys units) + Wraiths + Skorpekh. Can't table the C'tan — kill the no-invuln support (Praetorians/Immortals/Skorpekh), out-tempo, play the mission. The Deceiver's pre-game redeploy can wreck your screen — deploy reactively.

Traitoris Lance **COIN-FLIP**

Chaos Knights · 1 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Knight Abominant (psychic dread big knight) + War Dog Karnivore/Huntsman swarm. Lancer hunts the Abominant (or Volcano it), pick off war dogs, Rotate the focused Knight. Watch the Abominant's MW/psychic output — a knight duel with a caster.

Shadow Legion **COIN-FLIP → directional**

Chaos Daemons · 1 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Be'lakor + 2× Bloodthirster + Plaguebearer/Nurgling chaff. Bloodthirsters are fast melee monsters (Lancer/Volcano targets) — shoot them on the way in, screen; anti-infantry into the chaff. Be'lakor = -1 to hit, hard to pin. Directional.

Firestorm Assault Force **COIN-FLIP**

Dark Angels · 1 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Land Raider + Hellblasters + Redemptor + Eradicators + Azrael + Storm Speeder Thunderstrike. KILL THE STORM SPEEDER (its mark = +1 to wound you) and the Eradicators (melta) first; Azrael gives a 4++ bubble. Deny the delivery,

out-durable the plasma.

Hand of the Dynasty **HARD / play-the-mission**

Necrons · 1 pilots · sim EVEN

Nightbringer + Void Dragon C'tan (un-killable, -1 Dmg, 4++) + Warriors + Skorpekh + Lychguard. Same as the other C'tan walls — kill the no-invuln soft OC (Warriors/Skorpekh) at range, out-tempo on secondaries, never dump guns into a C'tan.

Rad-Zone Corps **UNFAVOURABLE**

Adeptus Mechanicus · 1 pilots · sim ATTRITION-NEGATIVE

Rad-Zone = chip-MW/battle-shock (no Toughness reduction) + Onager/Skorpius/Kataphron anti-tank + Cawl. Kill the anti-tank platforms + Cawl early, out-bodied on OC — win where you can at range, accept the deficit.

Cohort Cybernetica **UNFAVOURABLE**

Adeptus Mechanicus · 1 pilots · sim HARD

Kastelan Robots + Kataphron bricks + Belisarius Cawl (buff engine) + Skorpius anti-tank. KILL CAWL (the multiplier) and the Kataphron Destroyers (Anti-Vehicle) first; they out-body you and grind ~1 Knight/turn. Respect the loss, bank secondaries.

Armoured Infantry **UNFAVOURABLE**

Astra Militarum · 1 pilots · sim HARD

Leman Russ + Hippogriff AFVs + Cataphan bodies. Battlecannon/lascannon anti-tank chunks Questoris — kill the tanks first, weather the volume from cover; they out-body you on OC. Bank secondaries.

Seer Council **COIN-FLIP**

Aeldari · 1 pilots · sim EVEN

Eldrad + Warlock Conclave (Guide/Doom re-rolls + Fate dice) + Avatar/Fuegan + Fire Dragons (melta). Kill the SEER buff engine (Eldrad/Warlocks) and the Fire Dragons (anti-tank) first; Avatar/Fuegan are Lancer targets. Neuter the buffs and you out-durable.

Bastion Task Force **COIN-FLIP**

Black Templars · 1 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Repulsor Executioners + Land Raider delivering Crusader/Sword Brethren melee. Kill the Repulsor Executioners (anti-tank), pop the Land Raider before it disgorges, out-durable the marines. Don't let a gun-Knight get charged by the Crusader brick.

Eldritch Raiders **COIN-FLIP**

Aeldari · 1 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Durable Wraithguard/Wraithblades (T-heavy) + Avatar + corsairs. Wraithguard carry melta/D anti-tank — kill them before they reach you; Avatar = a Lancer target. Out-durable the corsairs, don't feed the Wraithblade melee.

Armoured Trailblazers **COIN-FLIP**

Leagues of Votann · 1 pilots · sim HARD

Einhydr Hearthguard (deep-strike Anti-Vehicle MELEE maul) + Hearthkyn + Sagitaurs. DENY THE DROPS (screen >9"), judgement tokens = re-roll wound + AP (invuln-negation) so don't let a Knight get marked-and-mauled; kill the Sagitaurs, out-durable if the maul can't reach.

Hallowed Martyrs **COIN-FLIP**

Adepta Sororitas · 1 pilots · sim HARD

Vahl + Paragon Warsuits (buffed melta HAMMER) + Castigators + Sacresants. Kill Vahl+Paragons first (real anti-tank; Paragons T7 2+/4++) — the rest are T3 W1, volume shreds them. Watch Miracle Dice on a key save/wound; out-durable once the melta's gone.

Designation Force **UNFAVOURABLE**

Astra Militarum · 1 pilots · sim FAVOURED

A WALL of superheavy tanks (Shadowword / Stormsword / Banesword / Banehammer). The SHADOWSWORD one-shots a Knight — KILL IT FIRST, then the Stormsword. It's a big-gun Volcano-duel: Rotate the focused Knight, trade into their hulls, hope to win the exchange. Genuinely dangerous.

Chaos Cult **COIN-FLIP**

Chaos Daemons · 1 pilots · sim EVEN

Bloodthirster + 2× Lord of Change + Great Unclean One + horrors — big monsters w/ FNP + Tzeentch psychic Dev-wounds. Volcano the greater daemons (commit real guns — they're warded/FNP), spread vs Dev-wound smite, anti-infantry into the Horrors/Plaguebearers. Kill-race the monsters.

Windrider Host **UNFAVOURABLE → directional**

Aeldari · 1 pilots · sim HARD

Windrider jetbike speed + Fire Dragon melta drops (Falcon-delivered). KILL THE FIRE DRAGONS before melta range; Windriders out-tempo and evade your melee. Expect a tempo/board loss — win on kills where your guns catch them.

Abhuman Auxiliaries **COIN-FLIP**

Astra Militarum · 1 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Baneblade/Stormlord superheavy tanks (big guns AND big targets your Volcano/thermal can one-shot) + Bullgryn wall + Leontus orders. Kill the superheavies, weather the orders-buffed volume from cover, out-durable the infantry.

Subterranean Assault **COIN-FLIP**

Tyrannids · 1 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Swarmlord + Old One Eye + Zoanthropes + Red Terror + Ravensers, deep-strike/burrow alpha. Deny the drops (screen >9"), Volcano the no-invuln big bugs (Old One Eye/Swarmlord), spread vs Zoanthrope smite, Lancer-assassinate a monster, kite the melee. Kill-race not OC.

Final Day **COIN-FLIP**

Genestealer Cult · 1 pilots · sim HARD

Purestrains + Aberrants + Hyperadapted Ravensers + Neophyte horde, cult ambush. DENY the ambush (screen every drop >9"), anti-infantry volume into the bodies, Lancer counters the Purestrains/Aberrants. Watch the return; kill what scores.

Goretrack Onslaught **HARD**

World Eaters · 1 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Angron + Berzerkers + Eightbound + Defiler. Shoot them on the way in (Volcano the Defiler + Eightbound), Lancer 4++ counters the lead brick, screen + kite — never get charged in bulk. Angron returns; don't over-invest, just deny the charge and out-shoot.

Rollin' Deff **COIN-FLIP**

Orks · 1 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Wazdakka + Deffkoptas + Warbikers + Meganobz — fast Kult-of-Speed dakka + rokkit. Their rokkit pop Armigers — keep them back; kill the Deffkoptas/bikes (their anti-tank + speed), out-durable the dakka. Fast, so deny objectives + kite. Winnable but respect the alpha.

Lions of The Emperor **FAVOURABLE**

Adeptus Custodes · 1 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Same as the other Lions/Shield Host: elite-but-few (Allarus/Wardens/Telemon). Out-OC, grind the bodies with volume, Volcano the Telemon + Caladius (not W3-4 Custodians), Lancer sweeps. Refuse the melee gang.

Penitent Host **COIN-FLIP**

Adepta Sororitas · 1 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Repentia + Arco-flagellants = high-S no-save glass melee (fights-first is the danger) behind the Triumph (Miracle-Dice engine). SHOOT THEM OFF before they charge — any volume evaporates them (no armour save). Screen the charge lanes, Lancer counters; kill the Triumph buff-piece.

Contagion Engines **COIN-FLIP**

Death Guard · 1 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Defiler + 3x Deathshroud Terminators + Lord of Contagion + Bloat-Drone, 5+ + +/-1 Dmg. Volcano the Defiler/Bloat-Drones (anti-tank engines), don't grind into the FNP, out-tempo; Deathshroud are a brutal counter-charge — screen your gun-Knights.

Canoptek Court **COIN-FLIP**

Necrons · 1 pilots · sim HARD

Canoptek Wraiths (fast, S-heavy melee, reanimate) + Doomsday Arks + Doomstalkers (big guns). Kill the Doomsday Arks/Doomstalkers (anti-tank, no invuln — Volcano deletes them), grind the Wraiths (they come back — don't over-invest), out-tempo. No un-killable C'tan here = more winnable.

Fulguris Task Force **COIN-FLIP**

Space Marines (Astartes) · 1 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Repulsor Executioner + Repulsor + Bladeguard + Calgar + Storm Speeder Hammerstrike. Kill the Storm Speeder + Repulsor Executioner (anti-tank/buff), out-durable the marines, watch the Bladeguard/Calgar counter-charge. Trade at range.

Combined Arms **UNFAVOURABLE**

Astra Militarum · 1 pilots · sim HARD

Basilisk indirect artillery + Hellhounds + Ogryns + Leontus orders. Kill the Basilisks (indirect anti-tank you can't hide a Knight from), out-body loss is expected — win on tempo/secondaries, don't sit still in the open.

Chaos Cult **COIN-FLIP**

Chaos Knights · 1 pilots · sim FAVOURED

War Dog Karnivore/Brigand swarm — small fast chaos knights. Out-activation risk (many war dogs); Lancer + Volcano pick them off, Rotate the focused Knight, hold OC10. Watch dread/fear MW abilities. Knight duel — first turn matters.

Path of the Outcast **COIN-FLIP → directional**

Aeldari · 1 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Skyweavers + Troupe + Solitaire + Falcon — evasive glass melee. Volume shreds them if caught; screen the alpha, out-durable. The Solitaire is a lethal but fragile assassin — don't leave a lone character exposed to it.

Imperialis Fleet **COIN-FLIP → directional**

Imperial Agents · 1 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Vindicare/Callidus/Eversor assassins + Deathwatch/Aquila kill teams. The assassins snipe characters (screen your Navigator/leaders, keep them >12" or tucked) and the kill teams punch vehicles. Low body-count — out-OC + out-durable, kill the kill teams. Directional.

Dominus Foebreakers **MIRROR**

Imperial Knights · 1 pilots · sim ATTRITION-NEGATIVE

Knight mirror — Castellan + Valiant (short-range monster) + Helverins/Warglaives. Gun-duel: trade Volcano/plasma into their Questoris, Lancer hunts their big knights, keep the Valiant at range (it wants to get close). First turn + Rotate discipline decide it.

Hexwarp Thrallband **COIN-FLIP**

Thousand Sons · 1 pilots · sim HARD

Scarab Occult Terminators (2+/-1 Dmg) + 2× Daemon Prince of Tzeentch + Mutalith + Forgefiend. Psychic Dev-wounds BYPASS invuln — kill the casters (DPs are warded, commit guns), spread vs smite, Volcano the Mutalith/Forgefiend; high-Dmg guns into the -1-Dmg Scarabs.

Daemonic Incursion **COIN-FLIP**

Chaos Daemons · 1 pilots · sim EVEN

Be'lakor + Lord of Change + Kairos + Rotigus — psychic Dev-wound + Fate/re-rolls + FNP monsters. Kill the casters (Kairos/LoC) at range, spread vs smite (bypasses invuln), Volcano the big daemons. Be'lakor's shadow debuffs + -1 to be hit — don't over-commit the Lancer into him.

Blade of Ultramar **COIN-FLIP**

Space Marines (Astartes) · 1 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Repulsor Executioner + Land Raider + Bladeguard + Gladiator Lancer + Calgar. Kill the Gladiator Lancer + Repulsor (anti-tank), pop the delivery Raider, out-durable the marines; Calgar's brick hits hard in melee — don't feed a gun-Knight. Trade guns.

Kabalite Cartel **COIN-FLIP**

Drukhari · 1 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Incubi + Scourges w/ Heavy Weapons (dark lances = ANTI-TANK that chunks Knights) + Ravager + Kabalites. KILL THE SCOURGES + RAVAGER first (their anti-tank), then out-durable the W-fragile bodies. Deny the Incubi charge; they're glass — volume shreds them.

Black Spear Task Force **COIN-FLIP → directional**

Deathwatch · 1 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Indomitor/Talonstrike Kill Teams (mixed elite marines, special-issue ammo = anti-everything) + Storm Speeder. Their kill teams punch above their bodies vs vehicles — kill the Speeder (buff/anti-tank), out-durable, deny the drops. Directional — verify.

Mechanised Assault **COIN-FLIP → directional**

Astra Militarum · 1 pilots · sim HARD

Leontus + Kasrkin + Tempestus Scion drops. Deny the drops (screen >9", Gaze bubble), kill the special-weapon teams (T3 W1 — volume deletes them), out-durable; fewer tanks than a gunline so more winnable.

Green Tide **HARD**

Orks · 1 pilots · sim FAVOURED

The hard counter: Ghaz + 100+ Boyz that come back. You CANNOT out-body or out-OC it and can't clear enough — anti-infantry volume into blobs, kill what's on the points, accept the primary loss, scrap for secondaries. Dodge it in the draw if you can.

Skitarii Hunter Cohort **UNFAVOURABLE → directional**

Adeptus Mechanicus · 1 pilots · sim ATTRITION-NEGATIVE

Ironstrider anti-tank + Skitarii speed + Cawl + a Callidus. Screen vs the Callidus (character sniper) and infiltrators, kill the Ironstriders (their punch); they out-tempo on Recon. Directional — verify.

Da Big Hunt **COIN-FLIP → HARD**

Orks · 1 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Ghazghkull + Wazdakka + Beast Snagga/Boyz + Kill Rig. Ghaz is a near-un-killable melee anchor (2+/4+ +/FNP, huge) — DON'T feed him; screen + kite, kill the Kill Rig + Boyz (soft OC), Lancer avoids Ghaz. Horde-lean = OC pressure; win on tempo where you out-shoot.

Realspace Raiders **COIN-FLIP**

Drukhari · 1 pilots · sim FAVOURED

Scourges w/ Heavy Weapons + 2× Ravager = dark-lance anti-tank + Kabalite/Wrack bodies. Kill the lance platforms (Scourges/Ravagers) early — they're the only thing that hurts you; then out-durable the fragile raiders. Watch Reconnaissance tempo.

Godhammer Assault Force **COIN-FLIP**

Black Templars · 1 pilots · sim FAVOURED

3× Land Raider Redeemer (delivery) + Gladiator Lancers (anti-tank). Kill the Gladiator Lancers first (they chunk Questoris), pop a Land Raider before it delivers its brick, Rotate vs the incoming melee. A delivery race — deny the charge.

Augurium Task Force **COIN-FLIP → directional**

Grey Knights · 1 pilots · sim FAVOURED

2× Grand Master in Nemesis Dreadknight (big psychic monsters) + Paladins + Purifiers. The Dreadknights are Lancer/Volcano targets (T-heavy, warded) that teleport + hit hard; kill the psychic buff, spread vs smite (Dev-wound bypasses invuln), out-OC the few bodies. Deny teleport drops.

Host of Ascension **HARD**

Genestealer Cult · 1 pilots · sim ATTRITION-NEGATIVE

Mass Neophyte Hybrids + Acolytes = a body horde with cult ambush. You can't out-OC it — anti-infantry VOLUME into the blobs, kill what's on the objectives, deny the ambush (>90%), accept the OC deficit and bank secondaries.

wh.sim positional simulator · mechanistic matchup analysis, not a win-rate oracle · 108 archetypes · field: Lone Star Open

2026.